Positive-Data Learning of Multiple Context-Free Languages under Fixed Finite-Monoid Typing

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Abstract

Fix a finite-monoid morphism $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ and a fan-out bound f. We study positive-data learning of multiple context-free languages under componentwise h-typed substitutability. We give exact set-driven reconstruction and a conservative explanatory learner, with polynomial-time hypothesis updates at bounded rule rank.

Our main quantitative measure is the total length of characteristic positive data relative to the size $\|G\|$ and original rule thickness θ_G of a reduced good MCFG presentation. At fixed fan-out and rank, boundary-window typings admit $O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$ characteristic data; combining a window with any fixed finite group yields $O(\|G\|^3\bar{\theta}_G)$, including noncommutative groups. We extend the cubic bound to typings with positive-image semigroup in the pseudovariety **LG** of local groups. For rank-one rules, every fixed finite typing has a grammar-size polynomial bound. An explicit non-context-free fan-out-two rank-one target separates fixed typed substitutability from arbitrary regular filtering. A complementary semilattice-indexed abelian-coset criterion gives polynomial characteristic-data length uniformly over auxiliary abelian groups, subsuming the abelian-filtered case even when the control monoid is outside **LG**.

We provide a computable rule-only witness budget and a separate distributional-representative upper bound. At the pseudovariety level, the local-group upper boundary contrasts with fan-out-one lower bounds from the companion CFG paper. The general higher-fan-out superpolynomial data lower-bound problem remains open.

Keywords: grammatical inference; multiple context-free grammars; positive data; finite-monoid typing; multidimensional substitutability; Gold identification; rule rank.

1 Introduction

Positive-data inference seeks to recover a language from positive examples alone [1,2]. Distributional learning identifies interchangeable factors or tuples; for MCFGs, Yoshinaka developed an observed-tuple learner and a general signature framework [13–15]. The latter already covers finite sort refinements, qualitative identification, polynomial-time updates, and characteristic-set cardinality. Our concern is instead the *total length* of characteristic positive data measured against an original grammar.

We fix a finite-monoid morphism $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ before observing the text and allow tuple substitution only between corresponding components of equal h-type. This finite bias may encode boundary windows or DFA transitions [5]; the MCFG still carries unbounded dependencies [30,31]. Fan-out fixes the tuple arities tested by the bias. Unlike approaches using membership queries or derivation controls [6,7,16,18,20], the learner here receives only positive text.

Contributions. For reduced good presentations at fixed fan-out and rule rank, prefix–suffix typings admit characteristic data of total length $O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$ (Theorem 4.9). The local-group theorem gives $O(\|G\|^3\bar{\theta}_G)$ for all fixed typings with positive-image semigroup in **LG**, including windows combined with arbitrary finite groups (Theorem 4.10). Every fixed typing also admits polynomial characteristic data at rule rank one (Theorem 4.5). A fan-out-two non-context-free rank-one target lies outside all untyped substitutable classes followed by arbitrary regular filters (Theorem 5.3). We distinguish the effective rule-only witness budget (Proposition 4.16) from existential bounds using short distributional representatives (Proposition 4.18).

A complementary *target-language* criterion applies to semilattice-indexed abelian cosets uniformly over auxiliary abelian groups (Theorem 4.24). It includes abelian filtering and one-marker switching (Corollaries 4.25 and 4.26). Thus local-group structure constrains the *typing*, whereas semilattice-indexed cosets constrain the *target*.

Scope and prior work. The qualitative reconstruction mechanism is an instance of Yoshinaka's framework [14, 15]; we verify the componentwise typed construction directly, without claiming a new general inference principle. At fan-out one, the prefix–suffix polynomial bound is due to Yoshinaka [12]; the companion CFG paper proves a window–finite-group sufficient condition and a lower bound for set-driven operators having characteristic samples for both members of a distinguishing target pair [25]. The present paper treats several-component substitution and strengthens the algebraic typing-side upper condition to positive-image local groups. The distinction here is the quantitative control of multiple tuple components and *original* rule thickness, rather than the potentially larger thickness of a typed refinement. All upper bounds fix the alphabet, fan-out, rank and control typing as stated. The open higher-fan-out lower-bound question is not resolved.

Quantitative meaning. The polynomial-time statement concerns reconstruction from the *observed sample* at fixed f, rank bound and typing; it does not assert that positive texts or shortest characteristic samples can be generated in time polynomial in the grammar size. The effective rule-only budget uses *generated* tuples and admits a polynomial-size derivation-DAG description, while the shorter distributional/coset witnesses are *existential* and need not be generated by the corresponding nonterminal. For the semilattice result, Σ, h, Y, η, f, r are fixed: its length-bound constants do not depend on the auxiliary abelian group, morphism, subgroup, coset map or accepting types.

Proof methodology and AI-assisted research. The general claims rest on the mathematical proofs presented here, not computational experiments. ChatGPT and Claude assisted with exploration, criticism and manuscript editing; their output does not constitute independent mathematical verification. The author is responsible for the results and their presentation.

2 Preliminaries

Throughout, Σ denotes a finite terminal alphabet, ε denotes the empty word, Σ^* is the set of all finite words over Σ, and $\Sigma^+ := \Sigma^* \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$.

2.1 Positive-Data Learning

We use Gold's explanatory learning model and restate the needed conventions so that the MCFG development is self-contained.

Definition 2.1 (Text and TxtEx identification)**.** We use Gold's explanatory identification criterion [1]. To handle the empty language, fix a pause symbol $\perp \notin \Sigma$; thus $\perp, \perp, \ldots$ is a text for the empty language. A *text* for $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is an infinite sequence over $L \cup \{\perp\}$ in which every element of L appears at least once. Pause symbols may occur arbitrarily, and $\perp$ is not an end-of-text marker.

The *content* of a finite prefix is the finite set $K \subseteq L$ of positive examples from Σ^* that occur in that prefix. Thus neither the positions nor the number of pause symbols, nor repeated occurrences of the same positive example, affect the content. A learner is a computable function mapping each finite prefix to a hypothesis grammar.

A learner *TxtEx-identifies* L from positive data if, for every text for L, there are n_0 and a single hypothesis grammar H such that all stages from n_0 onward output exactly H, with $L(H) = L$. It TxtEx-identifies a class when it does so for every language in the class. A sequential learner is *conservative* if it keeps its current hypothesis whenever the newly observed positive datum is already in that hypothesis language, changing it only when the datum is not generated.

For later use, fix a distinguished hypothesis code H_0 with $L(H_0) = \emptyset$.

Definition 2.2 (Set-driven reconstruction operator and characteristic sample)**.** A *set-driven reconstruction operator* $\mathcal{B}$ maps each finite positive sample K to a grammar $\mathcal{B}(K)$, depending only on the set K, not on presentation order or multiplicity. It is *sample-consistent* if $K \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}(K))$ for every finite K.

Following the characteristic-set viewpoint of de la Higuera [4], for a target language L, a finite set $K^\star \subseteq L$ is a *characteristic sample for* $\mathcal{B}$ if, for every finite set K, $K^\star \subseteq K \subseteq L$ implies $L(\mathcal{B}(K)) = L$. The case $K^\star = \emptyset$ is allowed. We use *characteristic data* as a neutral shorthand for the positive content of such a sample; whenever a polynomial bound is claimed, we state explicitly whether it concerns cardinality or total positive length.

This finite-sample notion is distinct from TxtEx learning: $\mathcal{B}(K)$ need not stabilize syntactically as the accumulated sample grows. The sequential learner will be introduced separately after exact reconstruction is proved.

Definition 2.3 (Positive sample size)**.** For finite $K \subseteq \Sigma^*$, define $\|K\|_+ := \sum_{w \in K} (|w| + 1)$. For a tuple $\vec{u} = (u_1, \ldots, u_d)$, write $\|\vec{u}\|_1 := \sum_{i=1}^{d} |u_i|$ for its total component length.

2.2 Finite-Monoid Typing

Definition 2.4 (Finite typing representation)**.** A finite-monoid homomorphism $h\colon \Sigma^* \to M$ is represented by the multiplication table of M together with the letter images $h(a)$, $a \in \Sigma$. Hence $h(w)$ is computable by a left-to-right product in linear time in $|w|$. For a tuple $\vec{w} = (w_1, \ldots, w_d)$, write $h^{(d)}(\vec{w}) := (h(w_1), \ldots, h(w_d)) \in M^d$.

Definition 2.5 (Refinement of finite typings)**.** Let $h\colon \Sigma^* \to M$ and $h'\colon \Sigma^* \to M'$ be finite homomorphisms. We say that h' *refines* h, and write $h \preceq h'$, when $\ker h' \subseteq \ker h$. Equivalently, the value of h factors through the image of h': there is a unique monoid homomorphism $\upsilon\colon \operatorname{im} h' \to \operatorname{im} h$ satisfying $h = \upsilon \circ h'$, after restricting the codomains to their images.

For two typings h and g, their product typing (h, g) refines both and satisfies $\ker(h, g) = \ker h \cap \ker g$.

Finite-monoid homomorphisms serve here as finite-state typings. Let $h_{\mathrm{triv}} : \Sigma^* \to \{1\}$ be the trivial typing. A DFA transition morphism for a regular superset of the target is another example [27]; only the induced finite summary is used, not a membership oracle. We call $h^{(d)}(\vec{w})$ the *yield type*. The prefix–suffix morphism below supplies the boundary typing used later.

Definition 2.6 (Prefix–suffix typing)**.** For $k, \ell \geq 0$, put $m_0 := \max\{1, k + \ell\}$. For a word w, let $\mathrm{pref}_k(w)$ and $\mathrm{suf}_\ell(w)$ denote its prefix and suffix of the indicated lengths whenever $|w| \geq m_0$, with the length-zero windows equal to ε. Define

$$h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}(w) = \begin{cases} w, & |w| < m_0, \\ \langle \mathrm{pref}_k(w), \mathrm{suf}_\ell(w) \rangle, & |w| \geq m_0, \end{cases}$$

using disjoint tags for the short-word and prefix–suffix elements. Put $M_{k,\ell} := h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}(\Sigma^*)$. For short words x, y and long elements $\langle u, v \rangle$, define

$$x \cdot y := h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}(xy), \qquad x \cdot \langle u, v \rangle := \langle \mathrm{pref}_k(xu), v \rangle,$$
$$\langle u, v \rangle \cdot y := \langle u, \mathrm{suf}_\ell(vy) \rangle, \quad \langle u, v \rangle \cdot \langle u', v' \rangle := \langle u, v' \rangle.$$

With this multiplication, $h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}(xy) = h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}(x) \cdot h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}(y)$. Since $h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$ is surjective, associativity is inherited from concatenation and $h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}(\varepsilon)$ is the identity. Thus $h_\Sigma^{k,\ell} : \Sigma^* \to M_{k,\ell}$ is a finite-monoid homomorphism.

A finite typing h is called (k, ℓ)-*boundary-determined* when $h \preceq h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$. Equivalently, equality of prefix–suffix types implies equality of h-types; a factor map exists on the image of the prefix–suffix typing.

For brevity, we call such an h a *boundary typing*.

2.3 Multiple Context-Free Grammars

We use the standard tuple-generating definition of multiple context-free grammars [30]; see also [31] for a general overview of MCFGs and related mildly context-sensitive formalisms. The general-rank notation below is used throughout the reconstruction and proofs.

Definition 2.7 (Standard MCFG presentation)**.** A *multiple context-free grammar* is a tuple $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$, where V is a finite set of nonterminals, Σ is a finite terminal alphabet, $S \in V$ has $\mathrm{fan}(S) = 1$, and $\mathrm{fan}(A) \geq 1$ is the fan-out of each $A \in V$. A rule R of rank $r \geq 0$ has the form $R: \quad A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r), \qquad \rho = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$, where ρ is the output template, $d_0 = \mathrm{fan}(A)$, $d_j = \mathrm{fan}(B_j)$, and, with

$$\Xi_j := \{\xi_j^1, \ldots, \xi_j^{d_j}\}, \qquad \Gamma_\rho := \Sigma \uplus \Xi_1 \uplus \cdots \uplus \Xi_r,$$

each $\alpha_i \in \Gamma_\rho^*$ and every variable in $\Xi_1 \uplus \cdots \uplus \Xi_r$ occurs at most once in the complete tuple $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$. We call this at-most-once condition *linearity*. The rule is *nondeleting* if every such variable occurs exactly once. Thus nondeleting does not mean that derived tuple components are nonempty; empty strings remain allowed.

For child tuples $\vec{u}_j = (u_{j,1}, \ldots, u_{j,d_j}) \in (\Sigma^*)^{d_j}$, simultaneous substitution of $u_{j,\kappa}$ for ξ_j^κ defines $\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r) \in (\Sigma^*)^{d_0}$. When $r = 0$, the rule is a constant rule and derives the tuple $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$. The tuple languages $L_A(G)$ form the least family, ordered componentwise by inclusion, that is closed under all rule applications, and $L(G) := \{w \in \Sigma^* : (w) \in L_S(G)\}$. Equivalently, a finite derivation tree rooted at A is evaluated bottom-up by the rule templates. We write $A \Rightarrow_G^* \vec{u}$ when such a tree yields $\vec{u} \in (\Sigma^*)^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$; this is a *terminal derivation*, and $\vec{u}$ is its *terminal tuple*. A terminal derivation $S \Rightarrow_G^* (w)$ from the start symbol is called *successful*. An f-MCFG has $\mathrm{fan}(A) \leq f$ for every nonterminal, and an f-MCFL is a language generated by an f-MCFG. A grammar has *rule-rank cap* $r_{\max}$ if every rule has rank at most $r_{\max}$.

At fan-out one, the formalism includes ordinary context-free grammars. A *linear context-free grammar* is a CFG in which every production has at most one nonterminal on its right-hand side; a *linear context-free language* is generated by such a grammar. This is distinct from the "linearity" condition on MCFG rule templates above, which means that each rule variable occurs at most once.

Fix a standard explicit symbol-level encoding of finite MCFG presentations and write $\|G\|$ for its length. The encoding counts the nonterminal and rule records and every terminal or variable occurrence in each rule template. All polynomial grammar-size bounds below refer to this encoding.

For integers $f \geq 1$ and $r \geq 0$, write

$$\mathsf{MCFL}(f,r) := \{L(G) : G \text{ is an MCFG of fan-out at most } f, \text{ with rule rank at most } r\}.$$

Thus f-MCFL $= \bigcup_{r<\infty} \mathsf{MCFL}(f,r)$, because every finite MCFG presentation has finite rule rank. When minimum rule rank at fan-out f is mentioned below, it means the language-level minimum over all fan-out-f presentations, not the rank of a particular supplied grammar.

We use f throughout for fan-out/dimension and r for a generic rule rank; $r_{\max}$ denotes a prescribed rank cap. Rule-template variables are always written ξ_j^κ, so that x, y, z (with or without arrows) remain free for words and observed tuples. Terminals in examples, including digits and #, are typeset in `typewriter` font.

When two nonterminals have the same fan-out d, we use $A \to B$ as shorthand for the unary identity-template rule $A \to (\xi_1^1, \ldots, \xi_1^d)(B)$. This denotes only the identity correspondence between components: at fan-out two, for example, it means $A \to (\xi_1^1, \xi_1^2)(B)$, not a swapping rule such as $A \to (\xi_1^2, \xi_1^1)(B)$. Likewise, $A \to \vec{c}$ denotes a rank-zero constant rule. These abbreviations are used for typed start links and for Rule (Link) of the reconstruction below.

The standard formalism allows rank zero, nonidentity unary rules, arbitrary finite rule rank, and deleting rules. A nondeleting rule $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)$, with $\rho = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$, is *nonpermuting* if, for each child B_j, the variables $\xi_j^1, \ldots, \xi_j^{\mathrm{fan}(B_j)}$ occur in this order when the parent components are scanned from left to right. Following Yoshinaka [14, Section 2.3], a rule is *λ-free* if no output template α_i is empty, and a nonpermuting rule is *nonmerging* if no α_i contains adjacent variables $\xi_j^\kappa \xi_j^{\kappa+1}$ of the same child. A presentation is *good* if all its rules are λ-free, nondeleting, nonpermuting, and nonmerging. We write ε for the empty word throughout; "λ-free" is retained only as Yoshinaka's standard name for this rule condition. We use good presentations in the completeness proof. The nonmerging condition ensures that, after the siblings of a child are fixed, consecutive components of that child remain separated by nonempty terminal material or by a nonempty sibling yield. This matches Yoshinaka's multidimensional-context convention. In particular, λ-freeness implies by induction that every component of every terminal tuple derived from a nonterminal is nonempty.

The normalization used below uses only the nondeleting step (f3) in the proof of Seki et al.'s Lemma 2.2, in the rank-preserving form recorded by Kanazawa, together with component permutation, explicit empty-component removal, and Yoshinaka's nonmerging conversion [30, proof of Lemma 2.2, item (f3)] [32, Section 2.1] [14, Section 2.3, Lemma 1]. Yoshinaka also notes later in Section 2.3, after Example 2, that for fixed dimension and rule rank these standard conversions yield an equivalent good grammar of size $O(\|G\|)$ [14, Section 2.3].

Fan-out and rule rank are distinct grammar resources. In particular, there is no blanket binarization theorem that preserves an arbitrary fixed fan-out for general MCFG/LCFRS presentations: reducing rule rank may require increased fan-out [24,33]. Accordingly the qualitative reconstruction below is defined without imposing a binary normal form or a known rank cap.

Reduced grammars. The nonterminal dependency graph of an MCFG has an edge $A \to B$ whenever B occurs as a child in a rule with left-hand side A. A nonterminal is *reachable* if it is reachable from the start symbol in this graph, and *productive* if its tuple language is nonempty. The grammar is *reduced* if every nonterminal is both reachable and productive.

2.4 Normalization

Proposition 2.8 (Good normalization with rank preservation)**.** *Let G_{in} be a finite standard f-MCFG of maximum rule rank at most $r_{\max}$. There is a finite good f-MCFG G_{good} of maximum rule rank at most $r_{\max}$ such that $L(G_{\mathrm{good}}) = L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$. For fixed f and $r_{\max}$, $\|G_{\mathrm{good}}\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$. If $\varepsilon \notin L(G_{\mathrm{in}})$, the two grammars are equivalent.*

Proof. First delete unreachable or unproductive nonterminals, then apply the nondeleting step (f3) from the proof of Seki et al.'s Lemma 2.2, in the rank-preserving form recorded by Kanazawa [30, proof of Lemma 2.2, item (f3)] [32, Section 2.1]. Decorating nonterminals by component permutations makes the grammar nonpermuting. Next decorate by nonempty-component patterns realizable by terminal derivations, as made explicit in Appendix A, and project away empty components; this removes ε at the start and makes every retained output template λ-free. Finally apply Yoshinaka's nonmerging conversion [14, Section 2.3, Lemma 1]. None of these steps increases fan-out or rule rank. With $f, r_{\max}$ fixed, component-pattern choices contribute at most 2^f nonterminal decorations and $2^{fr_{\max}}$ child-pattern choices per rule, while permutation decoration contributes at most $f!$ copies. Yoshinaka's conversion has the same fixed-parameter linear-size behavior. Hence the total encoding size remains $O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$. The derivation correspondence and the empty-component construction are recorded in Appendix A. □

This proposition controls size, fan-out, and rule rank, but it does not identify the rule thickness of an arbitrary presentation with the thickness after normalization. Thickness-sensitive statements are therefore first proved for good presentations. For reduced λ-free input presentations, including presentations with deleting rules, Proposition A.1 gives a polynomial grammar-size-and-thickness transfer to the good presentation used below.

2.5 Tuple Contexts and Substitutability

Sentence contexts. A *sentence context of arity d* is a word $E = v_0 \Box_1 v_1 \cdots v_{d-1} \Box_d v_d$ in which each named hole occurs exactly once, $v_0, v_d \in \Sigma^*$, and every internal separator $v_1, \ldots, v_{d-1}$ belongs to Σ^+. Let $\mathcal{E}_d$ be the set of such contexts. This is Yoshinaka's multidimensional-context convention [14, Section 3.1]. For $\vec{w} = (w_1, \ldots, w_d)$, write $E[\vec{w}]$ for the result of filling $\Box_i$ by w_i, and put $|E|_{\mathrm{fix}} := \sum_{i=0}^{d} |v_i|$. For brevity, we say that a sentence context E *accepts* $\vec{w}$ in a language L when $E[\vec{w}] \in L$.

Definition 2.9 (Tuple occurrence in a sample word)**.** Let $K \subseteq \Sigma^*$ and $w = a_1 \cdots a_n \in K$. Number the cut positions of w as $\textcircled{0} a_1 \textcircled{1} \cdots a_n \textcircled{n}$. For $0 \le i < i' \le n$, write $w[i : i'] := a_{i+1} \cdots a_{i'}$.

An *arity-d tuple occurrence* in w is a sequence of nonempty, left-to-right intervals $0 \le i_1 < i'_1 < i_2 < i'_2 < \cdots < i_d < i'_d \le n$. It determines the tuple $\vec{x} = (w[i_1 : i'_1], \ldots, w[i_d : i'_d]) \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ and the context $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$ obtained by replacing those intervals by $\Box_1, \ldots, \Box_d$. We identify the occurrence with $(E, \vec{x})$. For example, the two intervals spelling `a` and `c` in `abc` give the tuple $(\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c})$ and the context $\Box_1 \mathtt{b} \Box_2$.

For $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ and $\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^*)^d$, define its *d-tuple distribution* $\mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) := \{E \in \mathcal{E}_d : E[\vec{x}] \in L\}$. When d is clear, the superscript is omitted.

Definition 2.10 ((f,h)-tuple substitutability)**.** Let $f \geq 1$ and let $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ be a finite monoid homomorphism. A language $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is (f,h)-*tuple-substitutable* if, for every $1 \leq d \leq f$ and all $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$,

$$h^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = h^{(d)}(\vec{y}), \qquad \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) \cap \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y}) \neq \emptyset$$

imply $\mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y})$. Thus empty strings are not compared as tuple components; when ε belongs to the target, it is handled separately at the start symbol. This is Yoshinaka's nonempty-component convention for multidimensional substitutability [14, Section 3.1 and footnote 3]; see also Clark [8] for the CFG case. The restriction is substantive already at fan-out one: if ε itself were allowed among the compared fragments, the ordinarily substitutable language $\mathtt{a}^+$ would fail the condition because $\mathtt{a}$ and ε share a context but do not have the same distribution.

At fan-out one, every sentence context has the form $u\square_1 v$, so $\mathcal{D}_L^{(1)}(x)$ is canonically the ordinary two-sided distribution $\mathcal{D}_L(x) = \{(u,v) : uxv \in L\}$. Hence Definition 2.10 specializes, without any external convention, to the ordinary two-sided fixed-h substitutability condition on nonempty factors.

Typing–distribution equivalence. For $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$, write $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,h}^d \vec{y}$ if and only if

$$h^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = h^{(d)}(\vec{y}) \qquad \text{and} \qquad \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y}).$$

For fixed L, h, d this is an equivalence relation; the superscript is omitted when the arity is clear.

Definition 2.11 (The target class)**.** Fix $f \geq 1$ and a finite monoid homomorphism h. The class $\mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ consists of all f-MCFLs that are (f,h)-tuple-substitutable.

A target $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ is called *boundary-typed* when h is a boundary typing.

If $h \preceq h'$, then $\mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,h'}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$: equality of the finer h'-types implies equality of the coarser h-types, so the substitution conclusion available under h applies. At fan-out one this is the context-free part of the two-sided fixed-h condition just described.

For every $f \geq 1$, $\mathcal{C}_{f+1,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}} \cap f\text{-MCFL} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$, because the fan-out-$f$ condition tests only the arities $1, \ldots, f$. The possible loss of substitutability when the tested arity is increased is already present for trivial typing: Yoshinaka notes that $\mathsf{SL}(p,r)$ and $\mathsf{SL}(p+1,r)$ are generally incomparable and gives $L_{\mathrm{reverse}} = \{w\#w^R\}$ as a one-dimensional substitutable language that is not two-dimensional substitutable [14, Section 4.1 and Example 5]. The example illustrates that fan-out changes the tuple-context substitutability condition, not just the generative power of a grammar. No monotonicity of the learned classes in f is claimed.

For every $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq M$, the language $h^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc})$ belongs to $\mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$. Indeed, it is regular, and equal componentwise h-types give the same total h-value in every sentence context, hence equal tuple distributions.

Proposition 2.12 (Intersection and abelian filtering)**.** *Fix f and h.*

(i) If L_1 and L_2 are (f,h)-tuple-substitutable, then $L_1 \cap L_2$ is (f,h)-tuple-substitutable.

(ii) Let L be (f,h)-tuple-substitutable, let $\mathbb{A}$ be an abelian group, let $\varphi : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{A}$ be a monoid homomorphism, let $\mathcal{H} \leq \mathbb{A}$, and let $\gamma \in \mathbb{A}$. Then $L \cap \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathcal{H})$ is (f,h)-tuple-substitutable.

Whenever the resulting intersection is an f-MCFL, it therefore belongs to $\mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$.

Proof. For (i), equal-type tuples $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ with some context E satisfying $E[\vec{x}], E[\vec{y}] \in L_1 \cap L_2$ have equal tuple distributions in each L_i, hence in their intersection. For (ii), first observe that $\varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathcal{H})$ is (f, h_{triv})-tuple-substitutable. Indeed, if a common context accepts tuples $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$, then $\sum_i (\varphi(y_i) - \varphi(x_i)) \in \mathcal{H}$. By commutativity, for every other sentence context E' the difference $\varphi(E'[\vec{y}]) - \varphi(E'[\vec{x}])$ is the same element of $\mathcal{H}$, so coset membership is preserved in both directions. Trivial typing is coarser than h, hence the same coset language is (f, h)-tuple-substitutable. Apply (i). □

As an immediate consequence, for any $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq M$, abelian group $\mathbb{A}$, homomorphism $\varphi : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{A}$, subgroup $\mathcal{H} \leq \mathbb{A}$, and $\gamma \in \mathbb{A}$, every f-MCFL of the form $h^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \cap \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathcal{H})$ belongs to $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$. Thus one typing can support a family of targets while the abelian constraint varies; these factorizations are not supplied to the learner.

3 Exact Reconstruction from Positive Data

We define the finite-sample reconstruction operator, prove soundness, and then prove completeness using a normalized target grammar refined by yield type. The target grammar is used only to select a finite characteristic sample. Since every observed tuple component is nonempty, the rank of an enumerated composition witness is bounded by the length of the sample word containing it.

3.1 Set-Driven Reconstruction and Sample-Bounded Rank

Following Definition 2.9, enumerate all tuple occurrences of arity at most f in the sample K. The reconstruction uses one nonterminal $[\vec{x}]$ for every observed tuple value $\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$, together with a fresh start symbol $\widehat{S}$. It is not told which occurrences correspond to target nonterminals or rules; all admissible segmentations are enumerated.

Definition 3.1 (Composition witness)**.** Let $r \geq 1$. A *composition witness of rank r* in K consists of an observed parent occurrence $(E_{\mathrm{par}}, \vec{z})$ of arity $e \leq f$ together with a segmentation of the parent components into terminal gaps and nonempty labelled intervals. The labels are variables ξ_j^κ with $1 \leq j \leq r$ and $1 \leq \kappa \leq d_j \leq f$; every variable occurs exactly once, and for each fixed j the variables $\xi_j^1, \ldots, \xi_j^{d_j}$ occur in this order when the parent components are scanned from left to right. No output component may contain adjacent variables $\xi_j^\kappa \xi_j^{\kappa+1}$ of the same child. The labelled intervals induce child tuples $\vec{u}_j = (u_{j,1}, \ldots, u_{j,d_j})$ and determine a unique linear template ρ satisfying $\vec{z} = \rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)$.

Lemma 3.2 (Materialization of child tuples)**.** *Every child tuple induced by a composition witness is itself an observed tuple occurrence, and the induced template ρ is good.*

Proof. Because the parent is an observed tuple occurrence, the components of each $\vec{u}_j$ occur in their original left-to-right order in the same sample word. If two consecutive components of the same child lie in one parent component, the definition of a composition witness excludes their direct adjacency. They are therefore separated either by nonempty terminal material or by one or more nonempty labelled intervals belonging to other children. If they lie in different parent components, they are separated by the nonempty internal material of the parent sentence context. Hence the components of each $\vec{u}_j$ satisfy the separation condition for an observed tuple occurrence.

Every variable occurs exactly once, the components of each child occur in order, and adjacent consecutive components of one child are excluded. Therefore ρ is linear, nondeleting, nonpermuting, and nonmerging. Finally every parent component is nonempty, so every output component of ρ is nonempty. Thus ρ is good. □

Lemma 3.3 (Enumeration and sample-bounded rank)**.** *Fix f and a finite sample K, and put $n_K := \max\{1, \|K\|_+\}$. If a rank-$r$ composition witness has parent tuple $\vec{z}$ occurring in a sample word w, then $r \le \|\vec{z}\|_1 \le |w| \le \|K\|_+$. All composition witnesses are effectively enumerable. Under a rule-rank cap $r_{\max}$, those of rank at most $r_{\max}$ are enumerable in $n_K^{O(fr_{\max})}$ time and space.*

Proof. Every child tuple has at least one nonempty component. Linearity and nondeletion make the child components contribute disjointly to the parent, so $\|\vec{z}\|_1 \ge \sum_j \|\vec{u}_j\|_1 \ge r$; the remaining inequalities follow because the parent components are disjoint intervals of w.

An arity-d tuple occurrence is determined by $2d$ cuts. For a fixed rank r, a candidate segmentation has at most fr labelled child intervals, whose endpoints are chosen among the $|w| + 1 \le n_K + 1$ cut positions of the parent sample word. For $r \le r_{\max}$, assignments to parent components and terminal gaps contribute only a factor depending on f and $r_{\max}$, and the nonpermuting and nonmerging conditions are directly checkable. Summing over $r \le r_{\max}$ gives the stated bound. Without a cap, the displayed rank inequality restricts the effective enumeration to $1 \le r \le \|K\|_+$. □

Definition 3.4 (Capped and uncapped reconstruction operators)**.** Fix f and h. For $r_{\max} \ge 1$, let $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\le r_{\max}}(K)$ be the grammar $\widehat{G}_{\le r_{\max}}(K)$ with a fresh start symbol $\widehat{S}$, one nonterminal $[\vec{x}]$ for each nonempty tuple value $\vec{x}$ observed in K, and the following rules:

(Start) for every $w \in K \cap \Sigma^+$, $\widehat{S} \to [(w)]$, and if $\varepsilon \in K$, also $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$;

(Const) for every observed tuple, the constant rule $[\vec{u}] \to \vec{u}$;

(Comp) for every composition witness of rank $1 \le r \le r_{\max}$ with parent tuple $\vec{z}$, template ρ, and induced child tuples $\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_r$, the rule $[\vec{z}] \to \rho([\vec{u}_1], \dots, [\vec{u}_r])$;

(Link) for observed nonempty tuples $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ of the same arity d, the identity-template rule $[\vec{x}] \to [\vec{y}]$ whenever $h^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = h^{(d)}(\vec{y})$ and some $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$ satisfies $E[\vec{x}], E[\vec{y}] \in K$.

If $K \ne \emptyset$, define $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(K) := \widehat{G}(K) := \widehat{G}_{\le \|K\|_+}(K)$; for $K = \emptyset$, let $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(\emptyset)$ be the grammar with no productive start rule. Fixed encoding orders make both reconstruction operators deterministic and set-driven.

Exact relation to Yoshinaka's finite-sample grammar. The finite typing modifies Yoshinaka's constructor only at substitution links.

Proposition 3.5 (Typed guard on Yoshinaka's reconstruction)**.** *Fix a finite positive sample K, fan-out bound f, and rank cap $r_{\max} \ge 1$. Under the trivial typing, $\mathcal{B}_{f,h_{\mathrm{triv}}}^{\le r_{\max}}(K)$ agrees, up to notation, with Yoshinaka's hypothesis grammar $G(K)$ for $\mathcal{A}(f, r_{\max})$ [14, Section 4.1], except that the present construction handles $\varepsilon \in K$ by a separate direct start rule. For an arbitrary finite typing h, $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\le r_{\max}}(K)$ is obtained from that grammar by deleting exactly those Type II substitution rules whose source and target tuples have different componentwise h-types. The same statement holds for the uncapped reconstruction and Yoshinaka's $\mathcal{A}(f, *)$.*

Proof. The observed tuple values are the same nonterminal indices in both constructions. Rule (Start) is Yoshinaka's Type III rule, and Rule (Link) is Type II with the additional componentwise type test.

It remains to compare Type I with Rules (Const) and (Comp). A rank-zero Type I rule is exactly Rule (Const). For positive rank, suppose Yoshinaka has

$$[\vec{z}] \to \rho([\vec{u}_1], \dots, [\vec{u}_r]) \qquad \text{with} \qquad \vec{z} = \rho(\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_r),$$

where all displayed tuple values are observed and ρ is good. Choose an observed occurrence of $\vec{z}$ in a sample word. The displayed equality locates every component of every $\vec{u}_j$ as a labelled interval inside that occurrence. Linearity and nondeletion use each interval once, nonpermutation puts the components of each child in order, and nonmerging prevents direct adjacency of consecutive components of one child. Hence these intervals form a composition witness, so Rule (Comp) contains the same rule. Conversely every composition witness is a good algebraic decomposition among observed tuple values and therefore is a Type I rule. This also matches Yoshinaka's counting proof, where each Type I rule is enumerated as a factorization of a single sample word [14, Lemma 6].

Thus trivial typing gives the same Type I–III rule set, apart from the direct ε start convention. For general h, Rules (Start), (Const), and (Comp) are unchanged, and only Type II/Rule (Link) is filtered by componentwise type. Finally, in the uncapped construction every composition witness has rank at most the length of the sample word containing it, so allowing the cap $\|K\|_+$ introduces no Type I rule beyond the sample-length cap used in Yoshinaka's $\mathcal{A}(f, *)$. □

Example 3.6 (Why the equal-type premise matters). Let $L = \{\mathtt{a}^n\mathtt{b}^n\mathtt{c}^n : n \geq 1\}$ and $K = \{\mathtt{abc}, \mathtt{aabbcc}\} \subseteq L$. The observed factors $(\mathtt{b})$ and $(\mathtt{abbc})$ share the sample context $\mathtt{a}\square_1\mathtt{c}$. With trivial typing, Rule (Link) therefore connects their hypothesis nonterminals. The composition witness $[\mathtt{aabbcc}] \to \mathtt{aa}[\mathtt{b}]\mathtt{bcc}$ can then use that link to derive $\mathtt{aaabbcbcc} \notin L$. Under $h^{1,1}_\Sigma$ the link is blocked because $h^{1,1}_\Sigma(\mathtt{b}) = \mathtt{b}$ while $h^{1,1}_\Sigma(\mathtt{abbc}) = \langle \mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}\rangle$. This illustrates the local role of the equal-type premise.

The reconstruction is sample-consistent:

$$K \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,h}(K)), \qquad K \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(K)).$$

Indeed, each nonempty $w \in K$ has the direct derivation $\widehat{S} \to [(w)] \to (w)$ by Rules (Start)–(Const), while $\varepsilon \in K$ gives the direct start rule $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$.

These $\mathcal{B}$ operators are set-driven constructors, not sequential TxtEx learners: recomputation on growing samples need not stabilize syntactically (e.g. for successively longer $\mathtt{a}^n\mathtt{cb}^n$). The conservative learner below rebuilds only when a new positive datum is rejected.

Both reconstruction operators produce finite standard MCFGs of fan-out at most f and are effectively constructible from K, f, h. There are only finitely many observed nonempty tuple occurrences. Rule (Link) is obtained by grouping occurrences by concrete context and componentwise type, while Lemma 3.3 enumerates Rule (Comp). By Lemma 3.3, every rule of $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(K)$ has rank at most $\|K\|_+$ when $K \neq \emptyset$.

The concrete separation examples in Section 5 also serve as small instances of the tuple-nonterminal and composition mechanisms used here.

3.2 Soundness

Lemma 3.7 (Induced child context)**.** *Let ρ be the template of a good rule, let $E \in \mathcal{E}_e$ be a sentence context for its output tuple, and fix tuples of the arities required by the child nonterminals, with nonempty components, for all children except child j. Replacing every variable of child j by its named hole and every other child variable by the corresponding fixed component produces a context $E_j \in \mathcal{E}_{d_j}$ such that $E_j[\vec{u}_j] = E[\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)]$. If the sibling tuples are changed, the same construction gives the corresponding induced context E_j for that new sibling choice; the context itself need not be identical.*

Proof. Linearity and nondeletion make every variable of child j occur exactly once, and nonpermutingness puts $\xi^1_j, \ldots, \xi^{d_j}_j$ in that order. Between two consecutive variables of this child, nonmerging

ensures either a terminal symbol, a variable of another child, or a boundary between two output components. In the first case the separator is visibly nonempty; in the second it becomes a nonempty sibling component; in the third the corresponding internal separator of E is nonempty. Replacing the distinguished variables by $\square_1, \dots, \square_{d_j}$ therefore gives a context in $\mathcal{E}_{d_j}$, and filling the holes is exactly composition with ρ and then with E. □

Lemma 3.8 (Composition preserves equivalence)**.** *Let $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$, let ρ be the template of a good rank-r rule, and let $\vec{x}_j, \vec{u}_j$ have the arities required by its children and have nonempty components. If $\vec{u}_j \equiv_{L,h} \vec{x}_j$ for every j, then $\rho(\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_r) \equiv_{L,h} \rho(\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_r)$.*

Proof. Homomorphic template evaluation gives equality of the two parent h-types, and goodness of ρ makes every parent component nonempty. It remains to compare distributions. Let E be an arbitrary sentence context for the parent tuple. If $E[\rho(\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_r)] \in L$, replace the children one at a time. At step j, Lemma 3.7 supplies the induced sentence context for child j under the current sibling choice. Equality of the child distributions transfers acceptance from $\vec{x}_j$ to $\vec{u}_j$. After all replacements, $E[\rho(\vec{u}_1, \dots, \vec{u}_r)] \in L$. Reversing the replacements gives the converse implication. Since E was arbitrary, the two parent tuples have equal distributions. □

Proposition 3.9 (Soundness of every capped hypothesis)**.** *Let L be (f,h)-tuple-substitutable and $K \subseteq L$. For every $r_{\max} \geq 1$, if $[\vec{x}] \Rightarrow^* \vec{u}$ in $\widehat{G}_{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$, then every component of $\vec{u}$ is nonempty and $\vec{u} \equiv_{L,h} \vec{x}$. Consequently*

$$L(\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K)) \subseteq L, \qquad L(\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(K)) \subseteq L.$$

Proof. Induct on derivation height. Constant rules are immediate. For a Rule (Link) instance $[\vec{x}] \to [\vec{y}]$, its defining common sample context and equal h-type give $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,h} \vec{y}$; transitivity with the induction hypothesis proves the claim. For a composition-witness rule, the induction hypotheses give nonempty child tuples equivalent to the witnessed children. Every parent component of the witnessed tuple was nonempty; under the same nondeleting template it remains nonempty after replacing child components by other nonempty strings. Lemma 3.8 then gives the parent equivalence.

A nonempty start derivation begins with $\widehat{S} \to [(w_0)]$ for some $w_0 \in K \cap \Sigma^+$, so the empty unary context places the derived word in L. The direct rule $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$ is present only when $\varepsilon \in K \subseteq L$. The $K = \emptyset$ case is trivial, and the general hypothesis is the capped case with $r_{\max} = \|K\|_+$ whenever $K \neq \emptyset$. □

3.3 Yield-Typed Target Refinement and Finite Witnesses

Definition 3.10 (Template yield type)**.** Let $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \dots, B_r)$ be a nondeleting rule with output template $\rho = (\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{d_0})$, and put $d_0 = \mathrm{fan}(A)$ and $d_j := \mathrm{fan}(B_j)$, and choose $\mathbf{t}_j \in M^{d_j}$ for each $1 \leq j \leq r$.

On the template alphabet $\Gamma_\rho := \Sigma \uplus \biguplus_{j=1}^{r} \{\xi_j^1, \dots, \xi_j^{d_j}\}$, define $\mathsf{ev}_{\mathbf{t}_1,\dots,\mathbf{t}_r} : \Gamma_\rho \to M$ by $\mathsf{ev}_{\mathbf{t}_1,\dots,\mathbf{t}_r}(a) := h(a)$ for $a \in \Sigma$, and $\mathsf{ev}_{\mathbf{t}_1,\dots,\mathbf{t}_r}(\xi_j^\kappa) := (\mathbf{t}_j)_\kappa$.

Let $\widehat{\mathsf{ev}}_{\mathbf{t}_1,\dots,\mathbf{t}_r} : \Gamma_\rho^* \to M$ be its unique extension to a monoid homomorphism. Define

$$\mathrm{out}_\rho(\mathbf{t}_1, \dots, \mathbf{t}_r) := (\widehat{\mathsf{ev}}_{\mathbf{t}_1,\dots,\mathbf{t}_r}(\alpha_1), \dots, \widehat{\mathsf{ev}}_{\mathbf{t}_1,\dots,\mathbf{t}_r}(\alpha_{d_0})) \in M^{d_0}.$$

For rank zero, out_ρ is simply $(h(\alpha_1), \dots, h(\alpha_{d_0}))$, the componentwise h-type of the constant template.

The refinement below is ordinary finite nonterminal splitting: compositionality $h(uv) = h(u)h(v)$ makes each typed target nonterminal uniform in componentwise h-type, which is exactly the guard needed for substitutability.

Definition 3.11 (Yield-type refinement)**.** Given a finite nondeleting MCFG $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ and a finite typing h, the *full yield-type refinement* G^h has a fresh start symbol $\widetilde{S}$ and typed nonterminals $A_{\mathbf{t}}$ for every $A \in V$ and $\mathbf{t} \in M^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$. Set $\mathrm{fan}(\widetilde{S}) := 1$ and $\mathrm{fan}(A_{\mathbf{t}}) := \mathrm{fan}(A)$.

For each $\eta \in M$, add the start rule $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(\eta)}$. For each rank-zero rule $A \to \vec{c}$, add $A_{h^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\vec{c})} \to \vec{c}$.

For every positive-rank rule $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)$, $\quad \rho = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$, and every choice $\mathbf{t}_j \in M^{\mathrm{fan}(B_j)}$ $(1 \le j \le r)$, add

$$A_{\mathrm{out}_\rho(\mathbf{t}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{t}_r)} \to \rho(B_{1,\mathbf{t}_1}, \ldots, B_{r,\mathbf{t}_r}).$$

Here $B_{j,\mathbf{t}_j}$ denotes the typed copy of B_j indexed by $\mathbf{t}_j$.

Finally, the *trimmed refinement* $\widetilde{G}_0$ is obtained by keeping only the typed nonterminals and typed rules that actually occur in some successful derivation from $\widetilde{S}$; the subscript 0 denotes this productive/reachable core. From this point on, a "typed nonterminal" or "typed rule" means one of $\widetilde{G}_0$ unless the full refinement G^h is mentioned explicitly.

Proposition 3.12 (Yield-type invariants)**.** *For G^h and $\widetilde{G}_0$:*

(i) if $A_{\mathbf{t}} \Rightarrow^* \vec{u}$, then $h^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$, and erasing the type indices gives a valid G-derivation of $\vec{u}$;

(ii) every terminal derivation $A \Rightarrow_G^* \vec{u}$ lifts uniquely to a derivation $A_{h^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\vec{u})} \Rightarrow_{G^h}^* \vec{u}$. In particular, every successful derivation $S \Rightarrow_G^* w$ lifts uniquely through the start rule $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(h(w))}$;

(iii) $L(\widetilde{G}_0) = L(G^h) = L(G)$.

Proof. At a rule application, homomorphic evaluation of the rule template gives

$$h^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)) = \mathrm{out}_\rho(h^{(\mathrm{fan}(B_1))}(\vec{u}_1), \ldots, h^{(\mathrm{fan}(B_r))}(\vec{u}_r)).$$

The rank-zero case is immediate. Induction on derivation height proves (i), and the same identity gives the unique terminal-derivation lifting in (ii). Erasing the type indices gives one language inclusion. Conversely, every successful terminal derivation of G has the unique typed lifting described in (ii), including the uniquely determined start link $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(h(w))}$. Finally, every successful typed derivation consists entirely of rules retained by the trimming, so trimming preserves the generated language. □

Yield typing changes only nonterminal labels, so every typed rule has the same rule template as its untyped source. Hence λ-freeness, nondeletion, nonpermutation, and nonmerging are all inherited by the trimmed refinement.

For a typed nonterminal $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$, put $L_X := \{\vec{u} : X \Rightarrow_{\widetilde{G}_0}^* \vec{u}\}$. Trimming makes L_X nonempty; if the target grammar is λ-free, every component of every $\vec{u} \in L_X$ is nonempty.

Lemma 3.13 (Canonical contexts for typed nonterminals)**.** *Assume the target grammar is good. Every typed nonterminal X of arity d has a sentence context $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_d$ such that $\chi(X)[\vec{u}] \in L(G)$ for every $\vec{u} \in L_X$. If $\widetilde{S} \to X$ belongs to $\widetilde{G}_0$, one may take $\chi(X) = \square_1$.*

Proof. Choose a successful typed derivation containing an occurrence of X. At the root, the one-hole context $\square_1$ is valid. Follow the unique path from the root occurrence down to the chosen occurrence of X. At each rule on this path, fix the productive sibling subderivations used in the successful derivation and apply Lemma 3.7. Goodness of the rule and nonemptiness of the sibling components ensure that the induced child context again has nonempty internal separators. Iterating down the path gives $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_d$. The surrounding typed rule applications depend only on the typed symbol X, so replacing its subtree by any other X-derivation remains a valid derivation in $\widetilde{G}_0$. If $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is a rule of $\widetilde{G}_0$, the path has length zero and $\chi(X) = \square_1$. □

When $L = L(G) \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$, the refinement is also distributionally homogeneous for the sentence-context family used here. If $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$ has arity d and $\vec{u}, \vec{v} \in L_X$, Proposition 3.12 gives $h^{(d)}(\vec{u}) = h^{(d)}(\vec{v}) = \mathbf{t}$, while Lemma 3.13 supplies one sentence context accepting both. Hence (f,h)-tuple substitutability gives $\mathcal{D}^{(d)}_L(\vec{u}) = \mathcal{D}^{(d)}_L(\vec{v})$. Thus each typed nonterminal lies inside one distributional class for $\mathcal{E}_d$. This parallels, but is weaker than, the full-multicontext homogeneity used for congruential MCFGs [17]: our internal separators are required to be nonempty. For genuine tuple arity $d \geq 2$, the present sentence-context family still requires nonempty internal separators, so we do not assert an inclusion into the full multicontext congruential MCFG class; whether the empty-separator cases can be recovered uniformly remains open.

Definition 3.14 (Canonical tuples and contexts)**.** For every non-start typed nonterminal X, fix a *canonical tuple* $\omega(X) \in L_X$ and a *canonical context* $\chi(X)$ supplied by Lemma 3.13. Whenever $\widetilde{S} \to X$ belongs to $\widetilde{G}_0$, require $\chi(X) = \square_1$; otherwise choose any canonical context from the lemma. For a λ-free target grammar every component of $\omega(X)$ is nonempty, so $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \geq \mathrm{fan}(X) \geq 1$. Qualitatively a canonical tuple may be the first tuple in an effective enumeration of finite terminal derivations; the quantitative sections choose short canonical tuples. These canonical objects are target witnesses, not inputs to the reconstruction operator.

Definition 3.15 (Finite target witness set)**.** Let $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ consist of the following positive words:

$\chi(X)[\omega(X)]$	for every non-start typed nonterminal X,
$\chi(X)[\rho(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_r))]$	for every non-start positive-rank typed rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_r)$,
$\chi(X)[\vec{c}]$	for every non-start rank-zero typed rule $X \to \vec{c}$.

Because $\widetilde{G}_0$ is finite and all of its symbols and rules occur in successful derivations, $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ is a finite subset of $L(G)$; when $L(G) \neq \emptyset$ it is nonempty.

Lemma 3.16 (Target rule words occur in the enumeration)**.** *Let $R : X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_r)$ be a non-start positive-rank typed rule. Put $\vec{z}_R := \rho(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_r))$. If $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \subseteq K$, the witness enumeration contains $[\vec{z}_R] \to \rho([\omega(Y_1)], \ldots, [\omega(Y_r)])$.*

Proof. The word $\chi(X)[\vec{z}_R] \in K$ supplies the parent occurrence. The segmentation of this sample occurrence induced by the variables of ρ places every canonical tuple of each child as a tuple occurrence in the same sample word. λ-freeness makes all child components nonempty, nonpermutingness puts each child's components in index order, and nonmerging guarantees a nonempty separator between consecutive components of each child in the sample word. Thus every child canonical tuple is an observed tuple occurrence and the segmentation is a composition witness; exhaustive enumeration emits the displayed rule. □

Proposition 3.17 (Cardinality of the finite target witness set)**.** *Let $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ be the normalized target presentation from which $\widetilde{G}_0$ is constructed, with fan-out at most f and rule rank at most $r_{\max}$. For a fixed finite typing $h : \Sigma^* \to M$, the target witness set constructed above may be chosen so that $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \leq |V||M|^f + |P||M|^{f r_{\max}}$. In particular, for fixed f, $r_{\max}$, and h, the number of selected positive words is linear in $|V| + |P|$.*

Proof. The yield-type refinement has at most $|V||M|^f$ non-start typed nonterminals. The source rules give at most $|P||M|^{f r_{\max}}$ non-start typed rule instances. The construction selects at most one word for each such typed nonterminal and one for each such typed rule instance; fresh start links are handled separately and require no additional witness word. □

Proposition 3.17 controls only the number of selected words, not their total positive length $\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+$. Polynomial total-length bounds require the additional rank-one or boundary-determined arguments below.

3.4 Completeness and Exact Reconstruction

Proposition 3.18 (Completeness from a target presentation)**.** *This is the finite-typed counterpart of Yoshinaka's rule-witness completeness argument [14, Lemma 5]. Let G be a finite good MCFG of fan-out at most f, let $L_G := L(G)$, and construct its trimmed yield-type refinement $\widetilde{G}_0$ and witness set above. Let r_G be the maximum rank of a non-start typed rule, with $r_G := 0$ if there is none. For every finite sample K with $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \subseteq K$ and every $r_{\max} \geq \max\{1, r_G\}$, $L_G \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K))$, and also $L_G \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(K))$.*

Proof. For each non-start typed nonterminal X, put $\iota(X) := [\omega(X)]$. If $\widetilde{S} \to X$ belongs to $\widetilde{G}_0$, then $\chi(X) = \square_1$, so the reconstruction contains the corresponding start rule.

For a non-start rank-zero typed rule $R : X \to \vec{c}$, the two corresponding witness words share $\chi(X)$, and Proposition 3.12 gives the same componentwise h-type to $\omega(X)$ and $\vec{c}$. Hence the reconstruction contains $\iota(X) \to [\vec{c}]$, followed by the constant rule.

For a non-start positive-rank typed rule $R : X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_r)$, put $\vec{z}_R := \rho(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_r))$. Yield typing gives $h^{(\mathrm{fan}(X))}(\vec{z}_R) = h^{(\mathrm{fan}(X))}(\omega(X))$, and the two corresponding witness words share $\chi(X)$, so Rule (Link) $\iota(X) \to [\vec{z}_R]$ is present. Lemma 3.16 provides $[\vec{z}_R] \to \rho(\iota(Y_1), \ldots, \iota(Y_r))$. Induction on a $\widetilde{G}_0$-derivation therefore simulates every non-start typed rule whenever the cap is at least r_G; the fresh start link was handled above. Hence every word of L_G is generated. For the uncapped reconstruction, each required rule has a witness word in K; Lemma 3.3 places its rank below $\|K\|_+$. This simulation uses neither tuple substitutability nor $K \subseteq L$; those enter only through soundness. □

Theorem 3.19 (Exact reconstruction for a fixed typing)**.** *Fix $f \geq 1$ and a finite homomorphism $h : \Sigma^* \to M$. For every $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ there is a finite characteristic sample $K_L^\star \subseteq L$ such that every finite $K_L^\star \subseteq K \subseteq L$ satisfies $L(\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(K)) = L$.*

Proof. Put $L^+ := L \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$. If $L^+ = \emptyset$, take $K_L^\star = L$. Otherwise choose a finite f-MCFG presentation of L and apply Proposition 2.8 to obtain a good presentation of L^+. Let $\widetilde{G}_0$ be its trimmed yield-type refinement and set $K_L^\star := \mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$. The observation following Definition 3.15 makes this a finite subset of L. For $K_L^\star \subseteq K \subseteq L$, Proposition 3.18 gives every nonempty target word in the hypothesis, while Proposition 3.9 gives the reverse inclusion. If $\varepsilon \in L$, the direct start rule generates it; if $\varepsilon \notin L$, soundness forbids it. The cases $L = \emptyset$ and $L = \{\varepsilon\}$ are immediate from the reconstruction definition. □

The set-driven map that sends a finite text prefix to $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}$ of its positive content is eventually semantically correct: once the content contains $K_L^\star$, every later reconstruction generates L by Theorem 3.19. Its grammar presentation may still change as new positive examples enlarge the observed tuple inventory, which is why TxtEx stabilization is handled by the conservative wrapper below.

Definition 3.20 (Conservative sequential learner)**.** We use the same conservative update policy as Yoshinaka's Algorithm 1 [14, Section 4.1]. Let H_0 be the fixed empty-language hypothesis from the learning model. The learner $\mathcal{A}_{f,h}$ starts from H_0. On a pause symbol it keeps its current grammar. On a positive datum w, it keeps the current grammar if that grammar already generates w; otherwise, with K the positive content seen so far, it replaces the hypothesis by $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}(K)$.

Corollary 3.21 (Gold/TxtEx identification)**.** *For every finite-monoid homomorphism $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ and every $f \geq 1$, the conservative learner $\mathcal{A}_{f,h}$ TxtEx-identifies $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$ from positive data.*

Proof. MCFG membership is decidable [30], so the learner is computable. Sample consistency gives the invariant that every current hypothesis contains every positive example seen so far: a rebuild contains the whole current content, and a stage without a rebuild leaves a hypothesis that already contains the new datum. Proposition 3.9 makes every rebuilt hypothesis sound.

Fix a stage after the characteristic sample from Theorem 3.19 has appeared. If the current sound hypothesis is already exact, every later positive datum is generated and no further rebuild occurs. Otherwise choose $w \in L$ missing from the current hypothesis. The text eventually presents w, which forces a rebuild from positive content still containing the characteristic sample; that rebuild is exact by Theorem 3.19. From then on no further change is possible. The learner is generally presentation-order-sensitive and need not be set-driven. □

3.5 Polynomial-Time Updates at Bounded Rule Rank

For fixed $f, r_{\max}, h$, the construction is polynomial in the observed sample, as in Yoshinaka's bounded-rank learner [14, Proposition 4 and Section 4.3]. We encode observed tuples by cut positions and sample-word indices, and templates by ordered variables and terminal factors.

Theorem 3.22 (Polynomial construction under a rule-rank cap)**.** *Fix $f, r_{\max} \geq 1$ and a finite homomorphism h. From a finite sample K the complete encoding of $\widehat{G}_{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$ is computable in time $(1 + \|K\|_+)^{O(f r_{\max})}$. Its fan-out is at most f and rule rank at most $r_{\max}$.*

Proof. With $n_K = \max\{1, \|K\|_+\}$, cut positions enumerate all tuple occurrences in $n_K^{O(f)}$ time; fixed-monoid substring products give their types. Grouping by context and type enumerates Rule (Link). Lemma 3.3 enumerates Rule (Comp) and its encodings in $n_K^{O(f r_{\max})}$ time. The remaining rules have rank at most one, and deduplication leaves a polynomial-size complete grammar encoding. □

Corollary 3.23 (Polynomial-time conservative learning at bounded rank)**.** *For fixed $f, r_{\max}, h$, the policy in Definition 3.20 using $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,h}$ TxtEx-identifies $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h} \cap \mathsf{MCFL}(f, r_{\max})$ in time polynomial in the accumulated positive-sample size per processed datum.*

Proof. Rank-preserving normalization (Proposition 2.8) and soundness and completeness (Propositions 3.9 and 3.18) provide the characteristic sample needed in the proof of Corollary 3.21. Theorem 3.22 bounds rebuilds. Uniform MCFG membership for bounded fan-out and rank is polynomial jointly in the grammar encoding and input length [14, Proposition 4]; the parser saturates finite unary closures. □

At fan-out one every CFG admits a rank-two presentation, with ε handled separately. Thus $\mathcal{A}^{\leq 2}_{1,h}$ covers $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,h}$ without implying polynomial characteristic-data length at rank two.

Relation to Yoshinaka's general framework. At bounded rule rank, componentwise h-typing provides a finite-sort refinement of tuple substitution. The qualitative learnability conclusions are consistent with the scope of Yoshinaka's general signature framework [15]. We do not assert an exact identification of our reconstruction with the $\mathrm{SUBST}_{\mathrm{P}}$ construction on every sample; all results used here are established directly from Definition 3.4.

4 Characteristic-Data Bounds

Under a rule-rank cap, Proposition 3.17 already gives polynomially many characteristic words; this section controls their total length.

Condition	Characteristic-data control	Source
arbitrary h, bounded rank	polynomial in $\|G\|$ and refined thickness $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}$	Lemma 4.3
rule rank one	polynomial in $\|G\|$ alone	Theorem 4.5
$h \preceq h_{\Sigma}^{k,\ell}$, bounded rank	$O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$	Theorem 4.9
positive-image local groups **LG**	$O(\|G\|^3 \bar{\theta}_G)$	Theorem 4.10
semilattice-indexed abelian-coset targets	polynomial in $\|G\| \bar{\theta}_G$ (degree $3\|\Sigma\|+2$)	Theorem 4.24

The first row is the unconditional baseline for general h. The final row instead restricts the target language; its polynomial constant is uniform over the auxiliary abelian-group data.

Full yield-type refinement can make its thickness exponentially larger than the original presentation parameters (Proposition 4.4), so that route alone gives no original-thickness bound. Rank one removes the thickness dependence, whereas prefix–suffix-determined typing gives the main higher-rank transfer. The local-group proof uses the finite-group order-homogenization lemmas of Appendix B. The companion CFG result [25] separately excludes a universal original-thickness polynomial for arbitrary finite typing at fan-out one; the semilattice typing of that example is not determined by any fixed prefix–suffix window. Polynomial update time in the observed sample is independent of these data-length refinements (Theorem 3.22 and Corollary 3.23).

4.1 Thickness and reusable canonical contexts

Rule thickness and Yoshinaka's efficiency criterion. For the quantitative results, presentations are reduced and *good*, as in Yoshinaka's fixed-dimension, fixed-rank good form [14, Section 2.3, after Example 2]. For a rule R of G let $\theta_G(R)$ be the minimum length of a successful sentence derivation using R, put $\theta_G := \max_{R \in P} \theta_G(R)$, and define $t_G := \max_A \min\{\|\vec{w}\|_1 : \vec{w} \in L_A(G)\}$. Thus θ_G is rule thickness and t_G nonterminal thickness. Yoshinaka writes these quantities as τ_G and t_G, respectively, with $\tau_G \le \|G\| t_G$ in his notation [14, Section 4.3].

Lemma 4.1 (Polynomial equivalence of the two thickness parameters)**.** *For every reduced good presentation G, $t_G \le \theta_G$ and $\theta_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$.*

Proof. For $t_G \le \theta_G$, choose any rule with left-hand side A and place it in a successful derivation. Nondeletion preserves the tuple produced at that occurrence of A, so its total length is bounded by the final sentence. Minimize for A and maximize over A.

For the converse, fix a rule R with left-hand side A and follow a shortest dependency path from the start symbol to A. The path repeats no nonterminal. Keep the path child open, complete each sibling by a shortest terminal tuple, then apply R and complete its children likewise. Across the distinct rules on this construction, both explicit terminal material and child-variable occurrences are bounded by $\|G\|$, giving a successful sentence of length at most $\|G\| + \|G\| t_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$. □

Hence the two thickness parameters are polynomially equivalent on reduced good presentations. Yoshinaka's efficiency criterion asks for polynomial hypothesis construction, characteristic-set cardinality, and total positive data in target size and rule thickness [14, Definition 1]; see also [10]. Here characteristic-data bounds concern the capped set-driven reconstruction, while TxtEx

stabilization is supplied by the conservative learner. Proposition A.1 transfers the size–thickness scale for reduced λ-free inputs; genuine empty components may instead cause the exponential growth of Proposition A.2.

Lemma 4.2 (Reusable canonical-context bound)**.** *Let $\mathcal{G}_{\mathrm{t}}$ be a trimmed good typed MCFG with n_{typ} non-start typed nonterminals and maximum non-start rule rank at most $r_0 \geq 1$. Suppose that every non-start typed nonterminal Y has a canonical tuple $\omega(Y) \in L_Y(\mathcal{G}_{\mathrm{t}})$ with $\|\omega(Y)\|_1 \leq b_{\mathrm{can}}$, and that every non-start typed rule writes at most b_{rule} terminal symbols explicitly. Then the canonical contexts may be chosen so that*

$$|\chi(X)|_{\mathrm{fix}} \leq n_{\mathrm{typ}}(b_{\mathrm{rule}} + (r_0 - 1)b_{\mathrm{can}})$$

for every non-start typed nonterminal X. With these contexts and canonical tuples, every selected witness word has length at most

$$n_{\mathrm{typ}}(b_{\mathrm{rule}} + (r_0 - 1)b_{\mathrm{can}}) + b_{\mathrm{rule}} + r_0 b_{\mathrm{can}}.$$

Proof. If $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is present take $\chi(X) = \Box_1$; otherwise follow a shortest typed-nonterminal dependency path to X. It has at most n_{typ} non-start steps. Keeping the path child open and filling each sibling canonically costs at most $b_{\mathrm{rule}} + (r_0 - 1)b_{\mathrm{can}}$ terminals per step. Goodness preserves the selected components, their order, and nonempty separators, giving the context bound. Adding either one canonical tuple or one rule template with at most r_0 child tuples gives the displayed witness bound. □

4.2 Refined-Thickness Baseline

For a reduced good presentation G of an ε-free target, let $\widetilde{G}_0$ be its trimmed full yield-type refinement and put $\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}} := \max\{1, \theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}\}$, where $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}$ is rule thickness computed in the refined grammar. No comparison with the original untyped thickness is assumed.

Lemma 4.3 (Refined-thickness baseline)**.** *Fix $f \geq 1$, $r_{\max} \geq 1$, a finite alphabet Σ, and a finite typing $h : \Sigma^* \to M$. Let G be a reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r_{\max}$ presentation of an ε-free language in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$, and let $\widetilde{G}_0$ be its trimmed yield-type refinement. Then the target witness set has cardinality polynomial in $\|G\|$ and total positive length polynomial in $\|G\|$ and $\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}} := \max\{1, \theta_{\widetilde{G}_0}\}$.*

Proof. The trimmed refinement $\widetilde{G}_0$ remains reduced and good. A minimum-yield successful derivation using a typed rule with left-hand side X contains an X-tuple of total length at most $\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}}$, so use such tuples canonically. If $\widetilde{S} \to X$ exists take $\chi(X) = \Box_1$; otherwise remove the chosen X-subtree from the same derivation to obtain a canonical context with fixed material at most $\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}}$. Each typed rule writes at most that many terminals and has at most $r_{\max}$ canonical children, so every selected witness has length at most $(r_{\max} + 2)\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}}$. Therefore

$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \leq |V||M|^f + |P||M|^{f r_{\max}}, \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \leq (|V||M|^f + |P||M|^{f r_{\max}})(1 + (r_{\max} + 2)\bar{\theta}_{\mathrm{typ}}),$$

which is polynomial for fixed $f, r_{\max}, h$. □

For trivial typing, no nonterminal is split by yield type; consequently the original thickness scale is retained. This recovers Yoshinaka's untyped characteristic-data estimate [14, Lemma 7]. Without this uniqueness, the refinement may have much larger thickness, as the next proposition demonstrates.

Proposition 4.4 (Exponential blow-up of full yield-type refinement)**.** *There are a fixed two-element typing $h_{\mathtt{c}}$, reduced good fan-out-one rank-two grammars G_n of size $O(n)$, and a constant bound $\theta_{G_n} \le 2$, such that $L(G_n) = \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}\}^+$ and the trimmed full yield-type refinement $\widetilde{G}_{n,0}$ satisfies $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_{n,0}} \ge 2^n$.*

Proof. Let $M_{\mathtt{c}} = \{1, \zeta\}$ with $\zeta^2 = \zeta$, $h_{\mathtt{c}}(\mathtt{a}) = 1$, and $h_{\mathtt{c}}(\mathtt{c}) = \zeta$. For $n \ge 1$, view

$$S \to SS \mid \mathtt{a} \mid \mathtt{c} \mid A_0 \mid \cdots \mid A_n,$$
$$A_0 \to \mathtt{a}, \qquad A_i \to A_{i-1}A_{i-1} \mid \mathtt{c} \quad (1 \le i \le n)$$

as a fan-out-one MCFG. It is reduced and good, has size $O(n)$ and rule rank two, generates $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}\}^+$, and every rule has a successful use of length at most two, so $\theta_{G_n} \le 2$.

In the full refinement, the retained copy $(A_n)_1$ can derive only words without $\mathtt{c}$; recursively the unique such yield is $\mathtt{a}^{2^n}$. Hence the typed rule $S_{(1)} \to (A_n)_1$ has successful thickness at least 2^n. □

Thus full yield-type refinement admits no bound polynomial in $\|G\| \max\{1, \theta_G\}$ for arbitrary fixed typing, already at fan-out one and rank two. This is a limitation of the full-refinement route, not of the language $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}\}^+$ itself.

Prior lower bound at fan-out one. The publicly accessible revised companion CFG manuscript (see the fixed-commit source in [25]) establishes an exponential characteristic-data lower bound for a fixed two-element semilattice typing, already at fan-out one and rule rank two, for every set-driven operator that has characteristic samples for both targets of the distinguishing pair (including the operator studied there). We do not reproduce this prior CFG result. It does not automatically extend to higher fan-out, whose tuple substitutability tests more arities.

4.3 Rule Rank One: Grammar-Size Polynomial Data

Unary derivation chains admit a grammar-size bound independent of thickness, even under arbitrary fixed componentwise typing.

Theorem 4.5 (Rank-one polynomial construction and characteristic data)**.** *Fix $f \ge 1$, finite Σ, and a typing $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ into a finite monoid. For any finite standard fan-out-$\le f$, rank-≤ 1 grammar G_{in} of $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$, $\mathcal{B}^{\le 1}_{f,h}$ is polynomial-time in $\|K\|_+$ and has a characteristic sample of total length $\mathrm{poly}_{f,h}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$. The direct-start datum ε is added when $\varepsilon \in L$ without affecting this bound. The conservative learner $\mathcal{A}^{\le 1}_{f,h}$ consequently TxtEx-identifies $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h} \cap \mathsf{MCFL}(f, 1)$ with polynomial time per datum.*

Proof. Normalize without increasing rank (Proposition 2.8), and trim the typed refinement. Write $n_{\mathrm{typ}} \le |V||M|^f$ for its number of non-start typed nonterminals and $b_G \le \max\{1, \|G\|\}$ for the largest explicit terminal count of a rule, taking $b_G \ge 1$. Choose a typed terminal unary derivation that minimizes first total yield length and then the number of rules. No typed nonterminal can repeat: splicing in the later suffix would not increase yield length and would strictly shorten the chain. Therefore $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \le n_{\mathrm{typ}} b_G$. Lemma 4.2 bounds each witness word by $(2n_{\mathrm{typ}} + 1)b_G$, while Proposition 3.17 gives at most $n_{\mathrm{typ}} + |P||M|^f$ witnesses. Hence

$$\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le (n_{\mathrm{typ}} + |P||M|^f)(1 + (2n_{\mathrm{typ}} + 1)b_G).$$

The polynomial overhead of normalization and the time and convergence bounds follow from Theorem 3.22 and Corollary 3.23. □

This extends the rank-one untyped scale [14, Lemma 7] and the fan-out-one argument of [25] to arbitrary fixed finite typing at every fixed fan-out. Rank two cannot generally yield a grammar-size-only bound: the size-$O(n)$ grammar $A_0 \to \mathsf{c}$, $A_i \to A_{i-1}A_{i-1}$, $S \to A_n$ generates the singleton $\{\mathsf{c}^{2^n}\}$, which is (f,h)-tuple-substitutable for every fixed f,h: over a one-letter alphabet, sharing a sentence context forces equal total component lengths, so every context accepts both tuples or neither. Every characteristic sample for this singleton target contains a word of length at least 2^n.

4.4 Prefix–Suffix-Determined Typings: Thickness-Sensitive Data

Lemma 4.3 gives an arbitrary-h characteristic-data bound in terms of the thickness of the refined typed presentation. Proposition 4.4 shows that this refined thickness need not be polynomially controlled by the original good presentation. A stronger transfer is nevertheless possible whenever the finite typing is determined by a fixed prefix–suffix window. We formulate this boundary-determined regime in the same thickness-sensitive representation model used by Yoshinaka [14, Section 4.3].

Let $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ be a reduced good MCFG and put $\bar{\theta}_G := \max\{1, \theta_G\}$. Here θ_G is the rule-thickness parameter defined above. The argument is stated for the λ-free good core. If the target also contains ε, apply the argument to $L \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$ and add the single datum ε at the start symbol, exactly as in Theorem 3.19; this adds only one length-zero example and does not affect either polynomial bound.

Lemma 4.6 (Rule thickness bounds local terminal material)**.** *Let G be reduced and good. Then:*

(i) for every rule R, the total number of terminal symbols written explicitly in the template of R is at most θ_G;

(ii) for every nonterminal A, there exists a terminal tuple $\vec{u} \in L_A(G)$ with $\|\vec{u}\|_1 \le \theta_G$.

Proof. Reducedness places every rule in some successful derivation. Because a good grammar is nondeleting, every terminal written by that rule and every component of the tuple produced at its left-hand side survives exactly once to the final sentence. A minimum-yield successful derivation using the rule therefore bounds both its explicit terminal material and the total length of that occurrence's left-hand-side tuple. Maximizing over rules gives (i) and (ii). □

Lemma 4.7 (Untyped rule thickness controls canonical contexts)**.** *Let $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ be a reduced good MCFG and $\widetilde{G}_0$ its trimmed yield-type refinement for any fixed finite typing h. For each $A \in V$ of fan-out d there is an admissible sentence context $E_A \in \mathcal{E}_d$ such that*

$$|E_A|_{\mathrm{fix}} \le \bar{\theta}_G, \qquad E_A[\vec{u}] \in L(G) \quad \text{for all } \vec{u} \in L_A(G),$$

and $E_S = \square_1$ may be chosen. Thus for every non-start typed nonterminal $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$ the choice $\chi(X) := E_A$ meets Definition 3.14. With canonical tuples satisfying $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \le b_{\mathrm{can}}$ and maximum rule rank $r_{\max}$, every word in $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ has length at most $2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b_{\mathrm{can}}$.

Proof. Take $E_S = \square_1$. For $A \neq S$ choose a source rule R with left-hand side A. Because G is reduced, there is a successful sentence derivation using R and having length $\theta_G(R) \le \theta_G$. Remove the subtree rooted at that occurrence of A, replacing its d components by ordered holes. Lemma 3.7, iterated along the path to the root, and goodness show that the resulting E_A belongs to $\mathcal{E}_d$. Its fixed terminal material is part of the selected sentence, hence has length at most $\theta_G(R)$. Substituting any tuple from $L_A(G)$ gives another successful source derivation, so E_A accepts every such tuple.

By Proposition 3.12(i), $L_X \subseteq L_A(G)$; consequently E_A accepts every tuple of the typed X. The surrounding source derivation can also be lifted to the full typed refinement by Proposition 3.12(ii):

the type of X determines all ancestral types given the fixed sibling derivations, and the fresh start symbol admits every start type. In particular, $\chi(X)$ has the required common-context property. For a direct start link, $X = S_{\mathbf{t}}$ and the chosen context is $\square_1$.

A witness is $\chi(X)[\omega(X)]$, $\chi(X)[\vec{c}]$, or $\chi(X)[\rho(\omega(Y_1), \dots, \omega(Y_r))]$. Its context contributes at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ terminals; the source rule writes at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ by Lemma 4.6(i), and it has at most $r_{\max}$ child tuples. The displayed bound follows, with the rank-zero case included. □

Fix $k, \ell \geq 0$ and let $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ be any finite typing with $h \preceq h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$. Thus h factors through the surjective prefix–suffix typing $h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$. Let G have fan-out at most f and rule rank at most a fixed $r_{\max} \geq 1$, and let $\widetilde{G}_0$ be its trimmed full yield-type refinement under h. Let n_{typ} be the number of retained non-start h-typed nonterminals.

Lemma 4.8 (Short prefix–suffix-typed canonical tuples)**.** *For every non-start typed nonterminal X of $\widetilde{G}_0$, the canonical tuple may be chosen so that $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \leq f(k+\ell+1)n_{\mathrm{typ}}(r_{\max}+1)\bar{\theta}_G$.*

Proof. Choose, among all terminal derivations from X in the trimmed typed grammar $\widetilde{G}_0$, one with the minimum number of grammar-rule nodes, and then mark the root terminals needed to determine its componentwise $h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$-type: all terminals of a component shorter than $m_0 = \max\{1, k+\ell\}$ from Definition 2.6, and otherwise its first k and last ℓ terminals (one arbitrary terminal when $k = \ell = 0$). There are at most $f(k+\ell+1)$ marked terminals.

No typed nonterminal can occur twice on a root-to-leaf grammar path of this minimal derivation. If an upper and a proper lower occurrence had the same typed label, the lower subtree would itself be a valid typed terminal derivation from the same typed nonterminal, and replacing the upper subtree by it would strictly reduce the number of grammar-rule nodes. Every typed nonterminal occurring in this derivation is retained in $\widetilde{G}_0$; hence every root-to-marked-terminal path contains at most n_{typ} grammar nodes. Their union therefore contains at most $f(k+\ell+1)n_{\mathrm{typ}}$ grammar nodes.

Keep the union of these marked root-to-leaf paths as the retained subderivation. By linearity and nondeletion, each component of every omitted child contributes a contiguous interval to exactly one root component; it is never split between root components. Replace every omitted child subtree by a shortest terminal tuple of its underlying untyped nonterminal. Lemma 4.6(ii) bounds each such tuple by $\bar{\theta}_G$, and part (i) bounds the explicit terminal material of each retained rule by $\bar{\theta}_G$. Because the grammar is good, every replacement component is nonempty. An omitted child cannot contribute to a short root component: every terminal of such a component was marked, so any nonempty contribution from that child would contain a marked terminal and the corresponding root-to-terminal path would place the child on the retained skeleton. In a long root component no replaced block crosses a protected prefix or suffix position. Hence every replacement lies wholly in the unmarked interior of that component: the marked first k and last ℓ terminals remain literal prefixes and suffixes, and the component stays on the long-word side of the threshold. Thus the root prefix–suffix type is unchanged (and when $k = \ell = 0$ the single marked terminal preserves nonemptiness). Applying the factor map supplied by $h \preceq h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$ shows that its componentwise h-type is unchanged as well. Each retained node contributes at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ explicit terminals and has at most $r_{\max}$ omitted child subtrees. The resulting root tuple has length at most $f(k+\ell+1)n_{\mathrm{typ}}(r_{\max}+1)\bar{\theta}_G$. It therefore has the h-type indexing X. The replacements may change internal typed labels of the original typed derivation; this is harmless. We retain only the underlying G-derivation and the preserved root type, and then Proposition 3.12(ii) uniquely lifts that derivation back to G^h with root X. Since X belongs to $\widetilde{G}_0$, the lifted derivation can be inserted into a successful derivation through X and hence survives trimming. Its root tuple may therefore be chosen as $\omega(X)$. □

Apply Lemma 4.7 with $b_{\mathrm{can}} = f(k+\ell+1)n_{\mathrm{typ}}(r_{\max}+1)\bar{\theta}_G$. Every selected witness word then has length at most $2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b_{\mathrm{can}} = O_{f,r_{\max},k,\ell,h,\Sigma}(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$, since $n_{\mathrm{typ}} \le |V||M|^f$.

Theorem 4.9 (Polynomial data for prefix–suffix-determined typings)**.** *Fix $f \ge 1$, $r_{\max} \ge 1$, k, ℓ, a finite alphabet Σ, and a finite typing $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ satisfying $h \preceq h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$. Let G be a reduced good fan-out-$\le f$, rank-$\le r_{\max}$ presentation of a language in $\mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$. Then $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\le r_{\max}}$ is polynomial-time in the positive sample. A characteristic sample can be chosen with*

$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| = O_{f,r_{\max},h}(\|G\|), \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ = O_{f,r_{\max},k,\ell,h,\Sigma}(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G),$$

where $\bar{\theta}_G = \max\{1, \theta_G\}$. For a reduced λ-free input presentation G_{in} (deleting rules allowed), the structural good-form conversion of Proposition A.1 yields total data polynomial in $\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\| \max\{1, t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}\}$.

Proof. The h-refinement has at most $|V||M|^f$ typed nonterminals and $|P||M|^{fr_{\max}}$ typed rule instances. Lemma 4.8 applies because preserving the finer $h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}$ boundary type preserves the coarser h-type. Lemma 4.7 now bounds every selected witness word by $O_{f,r_{\max},k,\ell,h,\Sigma}(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$. Proposition 3.17 gives $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \le n_{\mathrm{typ}} + |P||M|^{fr_{\max}}$, with $n_{\mathrm{typ}} \le |V||M|^f$. Multiplying the polynomial number of witnesses by the preceding word-length bound, and adding at most one datum for ε, proves the asserted total-positive-length bound. The same successful witnesses also imply a polynomial bound on the refined typed rule thickness, but that intermediate parameter is not needed for the estimate. Theorem 3.22 gives the hypothesis-construction claim. □

The input-presentation clause follows from Proposition A.1; nonterminal thickness is used because deleting source rules may erase material before good-form conversion. Corollary 3.23 then gives polynomial time per processed datum for the corresponding capped conservative learner.

At fan-out one, this polynomial boundary-typing bound is not new: Yoshinaka's learner for (k,ℓ)-substitutable context-free languages already yields polynomial characteristic data in grammar size and thickness [12, Theorem 1], and the revised companion CFG manuscript extends the window result to finite-group refinements [25]. The contribution of Lemma 4.8 is to preserve boundary information simultaneously across *multiple* tuple components, giving the same kind of bound at every fixed fan-out $f \ge 2$.

The bound is relative to a reduced good bounded-rank presentation. Its original-thickness guarantee does not claim to cover arbitrary unbounded-rank presentations.

4.5 An Algebraic Criterion for Polynomial Characteristic Data

Write **LI** for the pseudovariety of finite locally trivial semigroups and **Grp** for the pseudovariety of finite groups. Their join $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ consists of divisors of finite products $S \times A$, with $S \in \mathbf{LI}$ and A a finite group [28, 29]. The following criterion makes the window–group hypothesis intrinsic to the positive image of the fixed typing. Its finite-semigroup ingredient also occurs in the companion CFG manuscript [25].

The typing-side principal bound is stated here; its algebraic factorization and noncommutative shortening proof are given in Appendices B and C.

Theorem 4.10 (Polynomial data for local-group typings)**.** *Fix $f, r_{\max}, \Sigma$ and a finite typing h with $h(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LG}$. For every reduced good fan-out-$\le f$, rank-$\le r_{\max}$ grammar G of a language in $\mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$, the capped operator $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\le r_{\max}}$ has a characteristic sample with*

$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| = O(\|G\|), \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ = O_{f,r_{\max},h,\Sigma}(\|G\|^3\bar{\theta}_G).$$

Lemma 4.11 (Locally trivial positive images admit fixed windows)**.** *Let $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ be a finite typing over a nonempty finite alphabet. If $h(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LI}$, then $h \preceq h_\Sigma^{q,q}$ for some fixed q.*

Proof. Put $S = h(\Sigma^+)$ and $q = |S| + 1$. For finite locally trivial semigroups, the identities $S^q = SE(S)S$ and $euf = ef$ for idempotents e, f and any $u \in S$ hold [25, 27]. If $w = pxz$ and $|p| = |z| = q$, write $h(p) = aeb$ and $h(z) = cfd$. Then $h(pxz) = ae(bh(x)c)fd = aefd = h(pz)$, where the middle factor lies in S even if $x = \varepsilon$. The window typing records shorter words individually and separates ε from nonempty words; hence equality of window types implies equality of h-types on all of Σ^*. □

Corollary 4.12 (Quadratic data for locally trivial typings)**.** *Fix $f, r_{\max}, \Sigma, h$, with $h(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LI}$. For each reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r_{\max}$ presentation G of $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$, the capped reconstruction has a characteristic sample of cardinality $O(\|G\|)$ and total positive length $O_{f,r_{\max},h,\Sigma}(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$.*

Proof. Apply Lemma 4.11 and Theorem 4.9. The refining window depends only on the fixed typing. □

Remark 4.13. The cubic bound for $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ follows from the stronger local-group Theorem 4.10, since $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$ (Proposition C.5). The locally trivial *quadratic* estimate above remains sharper than the general cubic bound.

4.6 Computing Short Characteristic Data

The bounds above are existential: each proof exhibits a short tuple or context. The shortest ones can be computed directly. Call a sentence context of a typed nonterminal X *derivational* if it arises, as in the proof of Lemma 3.13, from a successful typed derivation by deleting one occurrence of the subtree rooted at X. Every such context is admissible for X. The contexts E_A of Lemma 4.7, lifted to $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$, and those of Lemma 4.2 are derivational.

Proposition 4.14 (Effective short characteristic data)**.** *Fix $f, r_{\max}$ and a finite typing $h : \Sigma^* \to M$. Given a reduced good MCFG G of fan-out at most f and rule rank at most $r_{\max}$, the following can be computed in time polynomial in $\|G\|$, with lengths written in binary:*

(i) $\theta_G(R)$ for every rule R, and hence θ_G and t_G;

(ii) the trimmed refinement $\widetilde{G}_0$ and, for each non-start typed nonterminal X, a canonical tuple $\omega(X) \in L_X$ of minimum total length and a derivational context $\chi(X)$ of minimum fixed length, with $\chi(X) = \Box_1$ whenever $\widetilde{S} \to X$ belongs to $\widetilde{G}_0$;

(iii) derivation DAGs of size polynomial in $\|G\|$ representing these tuples and contexts, and hence every word of the witness set $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ of Definition 3.15 built from them.

The bounds proved using generated *canonical tuples and derivational contexts—Lemma 4.3, Theorems 4.5, 4.9 and 4.10, and Corollary 4.12—hold for this computed witness set. The semilattice–coset bounds of Theorem 4.24 instead concern an existential characteristic sample $K^\dagger$ whose distributionally equivalent tuples need not be generated by the corresponding nonterminals. Those bounds are not asserted for the computed set. Its words can be written out explicitly in time polynomial in $\|G\| + \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+$.*

Proof. For fixed $f, r_{\max}, h$ the full refinement G^h has at most $|V||M|^f$ typed nonterminals and $|P||M|^{f r_{\max}}$ typed rules, and trimming is a linear-time productivity and reachability computation. View the typed rules as weighted deduction steps. A rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_r)$ maps child lengths

x_j to $c_\rho + \sum_j x_j$, where c_ρ is the number of terminals written by ρ; this function is superior. To break zero-length ties without cyclic predecessor pointers, minimize the lexicographic pair (terminal length, derivation-node count), adding $(c_\rho, 1)$ at each rule. The pair-valued operation is strictly superior to each child even when no terminal is written. The shortest-derivation algorithm in the weighted deductive form of Nederhof [36], building on Knuth's generalization of Dijkstra's method for the grammar problem (see also Ramalingam and Reps [35]), therefore computes the minimum length $\lambda(X) = \min\{\|\vec{u}\|_1 : \vec{u} \in L_X\}$ of every typed nonterminal together with an acyclic choice of minimizing rules. These choices form a derivation DAG for $\omega(X)$, with shared subderivations. A second Dijkstra pass computes outside lengths, breaking equal-length ties by the number of edges. It starts with $\mu(X) = 0$ when $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is present. For every typed rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_r)$ and every j it adds an edge from X to Y_j of weight $c_\rho + \sum_{i \neq j} \lambda(Y_i)$. The value $\mu(X)$ is the minimum fixed length of a derivational context of X, and the shortest-path tree supplies its DAG. The same two passes on G itself give $t_G = \max_A \lambda(A)$ and $\theta_G(R) = \mu(A) + c_\rho + \sum_j \lambda(B_j)$ for $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)$.

For the generated-representative bounds listed in the proposition, the proofs exhibit generated tuples and derivational contexts within the stated budgets. The computed minima cannot be longer. By contrast, the semilattice–coset transfer uses distributionally equivalent representatives outside L_X and therefore does not imply the same bound for these minima. Expanding a DAG takes time linear in the length of the word it represents. □

Proposition 4.15 (Rule-only characteristic witnesses)**.** *In the setting of Proposition 4.14, choose all canonical tuples by the consistent acyclic minimum-weight derivations described there. For each non-start typed nonterminal X, let $R_X : X \to \rho_X(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q)$ be the first rule in its chosen minimizing derivation (including $q = 0$). Then $\omega(X) = \rho_X(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_q))$. Consequently the witness set of Definition 3.15 equals the set of rule-witness words alone:*

$$\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) = \{\chi(\operatorname{lhs} R)[\rho_R(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_q))] : R \in \mathcal{R}\},$$

where $\mathcal{R}$ denotes the non-start typed rules and rank-zero rules are included. In particular, $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \leq |\mathcal{R}| \leq |P||M|^{f r_{\max}}$, for a fixed typing and rule-rank cap. The set remains characteristic for $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ whenever the target is in $\mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$.

Proof. For each typed nonterminal X, an optimal derivation starts with a rule R_X. Every child derivation must have minimum weight: replacing a nonoptimal child by the chosen minimum would decrease the lexicographic weight of the whole derivation. The additional derivation-node tie-breaker makes the simultaneous choice of minimizing rules acyclic. Hence the displayed identity for $\omega(X)$ holds, also for rank zero.

It follows that $\chi(X)[\omega(X)]$ is *identical* to the witness word of R_X. Every other term in Definition 3.15 is already a rule witness. Thus the two sets coincide as sets of terminal words; in particular, the completeness and characteristic-sample arguments using $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ are unchanged. There is at most one selected word per rule instance. The refinement bound on the number of typed rules gives the displayed cardinality estimate. □

Proposition 4.16 (A computable presentation-sensitive data budget)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Proposition 4.14, let $\mathcal{R}$ be the non-start typed rules of $\widetilde{G}_0$. Let $\lambda(X)$ be the minimum total yield length from X, and let $\mu(X)$ be the minimum fixed length of a derivational sentence context of X (with $\mu(X) = 0$ for a direct start link). For $R : X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q)$, put*

$$b(R) := c_\rho + \sum_{j=1}^{q} \lambda(Y_j), \qquad \mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}(G, h) := \sum_{R \in \mathcal{R}} \big(1 + \mu(\operatorname{lhs} R) + b(R)\big).$$

There is a computable witness set $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ *with* $\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le \mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}(G,h)$. *The integer* $\mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}(G,h)$ *is computable in polynomial time in* $\|G\|$ *when* $f, r_{\max}, h$ *are fixed, with its value represented in binary. If* $L(G)$ *also contains the empty word and its nonempty core is treated separately, the optional* ε *datum adds at most one to the encoded budget.*

Proof. Use the minimizing canonical tuples and derivational contexts constructed in Proposition 4.14. By Proposition 4.15, every canonical-nonterminal witness is already one of the rule witnesses. For each positive-rank or rank-zero typed rule $R : X \to \rho(Y_1, \dots, Y_q)$, its witness word $\chi(X)[\rho(\omega(Y_1), \dots, \omega(Y_q))]$ has length exactly $\mu(X) + b(R)$. Summing the encoded lengths $|w| + 1$ over this indexed multiset of rule witnesses gives $\mathsf{B}_{\mathrm{rule}}(G,h)$. Passing to the set of distinct words can only lower the total length. The computations of λ, μ, the number of typed symbols and rules, and the binary lengths of these quantities are polynomially bounded as in Proposition 4.14. □

Remark 4.17. This *rule-only* budget is presentation-sensitive and can be much smaller than substituting worst-case maxima into the polynomial bounds. It is an efficiently computable *upper certificate*, not a claim of a minimum-size characteristic sample or an improved worst-case polynomial exponent.

The singleton $\{\mathsf{c}^{2^n}\}$ after Theorem 4.5 shows that explicit characteristic words can be exponentially longer than $\|G\|$. In that case the derivation DAGs of Proposition 4.14 remain of polynomial size, so the computed sample has a polynomial-size compressed description.

4.7 Distributional Representatives and Semilattice-Indexed Cosets

The computable rule-only budget above uses representatives *generated by* the typed grammar. For an existential characteristic-sample bound there is a different option: choose short representatives of the same *typed distribution classes*, even when the representatives themselves have no derivation from the corresponding nonterminal.

Proposition 4.18 (Relaxed distributional witnesses)**.** *Let* G *be a reduced good fan-out-*$\le f$*, rank-*$\le r$ *presentation of* $L = L(G) \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$*, and let* $\widetilde{G}_0$ *be its trimmed yield-type refinement. For every non-start typed nonterminal* X*, let* $[X]$ *be the* $\equiv_{L,h}$*-class containing* L_X*, and put* $\kappa_G(X) = \min_{\vec{v} \in [X]} \|\vec{v}\|_1$, $\kappa_G = \max_X \kappa_G(X)$. *There exists a characteristic positive sample* $K^\dagger$ *for both the capped operator* $\mathcal{B}^{\le r}_{f,h}$ *(with cap at least the rank of* G*) and the uncapped* $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}$ *satisfying*

$$|K^\dagger| \le |V||M|^f + |P||M|^{fr},$$
$$\|K^\dagger\|_+ \le (|V||M|^f + |P||M|^{fr})(1 + \theta_G + \|G\| + (r+1)\kappa_G).$$

The bound concerns the nonempty core; if $\varepsilon \in L$*, add the sample word* ε *at encoded cost one.*

Proof. For each $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$ choose a tuple $\omega^\dagger(X) \in [X]$ of total length $\kappa_G(X)$. Choose a derivational sentence context $\chi^\dagger(X)$ for the *untyped* A using a shortest successful derivation containing an occurrence of A, with all sibling yields fixed. The fixed material of this context is at most θ_G, since any such successful derivation witnesses some rule involving A; if $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is a start link, use $\square_1$ instead. This context accepts a tuple $u \in L_X$. As $\omega^\dagger(X) \equiv_{L,h} u$, it also accepts $\omega^\dagger(X)$.

Form $K^\dagger$ from all words $\chi^\dagger(X)[\omega^\dagger(X)]$, all rule words $\chi^\dagger(X)[\rho(\omega^\dagger(Y_1), \dots, \omega^\dagger(Y_q))]$, and all rank-zero rule witnesses. By Lemma 3.8, the rule tuple in the second family is distributionally equivalent to a tuple in L_X, so every listed word belongs to L. The proof of Proposition 3.18 now works with $\iota(X) = [\omega^\dagger(X)]$: the chosen contexts supply the Link instances, while the rule words expose the required composition witnesses. Proposition 3.9 gives the reverse inclusion for arbitrary larger positive samples.

There is one word per typed nonterminal and one per typed rule before deduplication. A nonterminal witness has length at most $\theta_G + \kappa_G$, and a rule witness at most $\theta_G + \|G\| + r\kappa_G$. Summing the encoded costs gives the bound. Unlike Proposition 4.15, these representatives need not be generated by their nonterminals, so the nonterminal words cannot in general be omitted. □

Remark 4.19. For fixed f, r, h, the preceding bound implies that any family G_n with $\|G_n\| \max\{1, \theta_{G_n}\} = n^{O(1)}$ and superpolynomial characteristic-data requirements must satisfy $\kappa_{G_n} = n^{\omega(1)}$. This is a necessary condition, not a proof that such a family exists. The relaxed construction is existential; the rule-only algorithm of Proposition 4.16 is a distinct, effective construction using grammar-generated representatives.

Lemma 4.20 (Short quotient-value representatives imply short data)**.** *Fix Σ, h, f, r as above, with $r \geq 1$, and let G be a reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r$ presentation of $L = L(G) \subseteq \Sigma^+$ in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$. Let $\mathbb{A}$ be an abelian group, $\varphi : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{A}$ a morphism, $\mathcal{H} \leq \mathbb{A}$, and $\pi : \mathbb{A} \to \mathbb{A}/\mathcal{H}$ the quotient map. Assume:*

(i) If nonempty w, w' have $h(w) = h(w')$ and $\pi\varphi(w) = \pi\varphi(w')$, then $w \in L$ iff $w' \in L$.

(ii) For every non-start typed symbol $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$ of the trimmed yield-type refinement, $\pi\varphi(\vec{u})$ is constant as $\vec{u}$ ranges over L_X.

(iii) For each untyped nonterminal A and each $\alpha \in \pi\varphi(L_A)$, there exists a tuple $\omega_A^\alpha \in L_A$ with $\pi\varphi(\omega_A^\alpha) = \alpha$ and $\|\omega_A^\alpha\|_1 \leq B$, for some $B \geq 1$.

Put $m = |\Sigma|$ and $T = (r+1)B + \|G\|$. There is a constant C depending only on Σ, h, f, r such that $\kappa_G \leq C(T+1)^{3m+1}$. Consequently, the capped and uncapped reconstruction operators admit a characteristic sample $K^\dagger \subseteq L$ with

$$|K^\dagger| \leq |V||M|^f + |P||M|^{fr},$$
$$\|K^\dagger\|_+ \leq (|V||M|^f + |P||M|^{fr})(1 + \theta_G + \|G\| + (r+1)C(T+1)^{3m+1}).$$

Proof. Let $\psi : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{N}^\Sigma$ be the Parikh map, $\Psi(\vec{u}) = \sum_i \psi(u_i)$, and let $\widehat{\varphi} : \mathbb{Z}^\Sigma \to \mathbb{A}$ extend φ. Put $\Lambda = \widehat{\varphi}^{-1}(\mathcal{H})$, $\Gamma_T = \{\delta \in \Lambda : \|\delta\|_1 \leq T\}$, and $\Lambda_T = \langle \Gamma_T \rangle$. For a rule $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_q)$ and child quotient values α_j, set $\vec{z} = \rho(\omega_{B_1}^{\alpha_1}, \ldots, \omega_{B_q}^{\alpha_q})$ and $\alpha = \pi\varphi(\vec{z})$. By nondeletion and commutativity,

$$\delta_{R,\boldsymbol{\alpha}} := \Psi(\omega_A^\alpha) - \Psi(\vec{z}) \in \Lambda, \qquad \|\delta_{R,\boldsymbol{\alpha}}\|_1 \leq (r+1)B + \|G\| = T.$$

Induction on terminal derivations (including rank-zero rules) therefore yields, for every $\vec{u} \in L_A$,

$$\Psi(\vec{u}) - \Psi(\omega_A^{\pi\varphi(\vec{u})}) \in \Lambda_T. \tag{1}$$

Indeed, at the root the left-hand difference equals the sum of the analogous child differences minus $\delta_{R,\boldsymbol{\alpha}}$.

Fix a non-start typed symbol $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$ of arity $d \leq f$ and $\vec{u} = (u_1, \ldots, u_d) \in L_X$. By (ii), its quotient value α_X is independent of the chosen $\vec{u}$; put $\vec{\omega} = \omega_A^{\alpha_X}$. For each component type t_i, the Parikh image of the fixed regular language $h^{-1}(t_i) \cap \Sigma^+$ has a finite semilinear representation. Since Σ and h are fixed, the number and ℓ_1-norms of its base and period vectors are bounded by a constant C_h. Choose a linear-set cell $c_i + \sum_{p \in P_i} \mathbb{N}p$ containing $\psi(u_i)$ and consider the following system in nonnegative integers:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{d} \sum_{p \in P_i} \nu_{i,p} p - \sum_{\delta \in \Gamma_T} (\mu_\delta^+ - \mu_\delta^-)\delta = \Psi(\vec{\omega}) - \sum_{i=1}^{d} c_i. \tag{2}$$

By (1), the original tuple witnesses feasibility. There are m equations, at most $n = fC_h + 2(2T+1)^m$ variables, and all coefficients and right-hand-side entries have absolute value at most $a = T + fC_h$ (increasing C_h if necessary). Papadimitriou's small nonnegative integral solution bound [41] supplies a solution with each variable at most $n(ma)^{2m+1}$. For each resulting vector $q_i = c_i + \sum_p \nu_{i,p} p$ choose a nonempty $v_i \in h^{-1}(t_i)$ having $\psi(v_i) = q_i$; the definition of the selected linear set guarantees existence. The tuple $\vec{v} = (v_1, \dots, v_d)$ satisfies

$$h^{(d)}(\vec{v}) = \mathbf{t}, \qquad \Psi(\vec{v}) - \Psi(\vec{\omega}) \in \Lambda_T, \qquad \|\vec{v}\|_1 = O_{\Sigma,h,f}((T+1)^{3m+1}).$$

Together with (1), this implies $\pi\varphi(\vec{v}) = \pi\varphi(\vec{u})$. For every sentence context E, componentwise equality of h-types gives $h(E[\vec{v}]) = h(E[\vec{u}])$, while abelian additivity gives $\pi\varphi(E[\vec{v}]) = \pi\varphi(E[\vec{u}])$. Both filled words are nonempty, so assumption (i) yields $E[\vec{v}] \in L$ iff $E[\vec{u}] \in L$. Thus $\vec{v} \equiv_{L,h} \vec{u}$, and the bound for κ_G follows. Apply Proposition 4.18 for the sample bounds. The argument is existential and does not require a computable presentation of the auxiliary group. □

Semilattice-indexed quotient values. Fix a finite join-semilattice $(Y, \vee, \bot)$ and a monoid morphism $\eta : \Sigma^* \to Y$ such that $\eta \preceq h$. Write $\eta(\vec{u}) = \bigvee_i \eta(u_i)$. Let $\gamma : Y \to \mathbb{A}$ be any map and $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq M$. Consider the nonempty target

$$L = \{w \in \Sigma^+ : h(w) \in \mathsf{Acc},\ \varphi(w) \in \gamma(\eta(w)) + \mathcal{H}\}. \tag{3}$$

A common accepting context for two tuples of equal componentwise h-type forces their total φ-values to agree modulo $\mathcal{H}$. This persists under every context, since both the h-type and η-value of the filled words then agree. Thus, whenever it is an f-MCFL, the language in (3) lies in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$.

Fix a reduced good presentation G of (3). For a nonterminal A put $D_A = \eta(L_A)$ and write $Q = \mathbb{A}/\mathcal{H}$. For a finite semilattice define $\mathrm{ht}(y)$ to be the length of a longest strict chain from $\bot$ to y, and put $\nu(A) = \max_{y \in D_A} \mathrm{ht}(y)$. A nonterminal is *multivalued* if its realized tuples have at least two distinct φ-values in Q.

Lemma 4.21 (Semilattice values and rectangle rigidity)**.** *For every A there is a well-defined map $F_A : D_A \to Q$ satisfying $F_A(\eta(\vec{u})) = \pi\varphi(\vec{u})$ for $\vec{u} \in L_A$. Moreover, for any rule $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \dots, B_q)$, index j, and fixed sibling tuples $\vec{v}_i \in L_{B_i}$ for $i \neq j$, put $W = \eta(\rho) \vee \bigvee_{i \neq j} \eta(\vec{v}_i)$, where $\eta(\rho)$ is the join of the terminal letters written in the rule. If $y, y' \in D_{B_j}$ and $y \vee W = y' \vee W$, then $F_{B_j}(y) = F_{B_j}(y')$.*

Proof. Reducedness gives each A a derivational sentence context E accepting every member of L_A. For any such tuple, $\pi\varphi(\vec{u}) = \pi(\gamma(\eta(E) \vee \eta(\vec{u})) - \varphi(E))$, so the left-hand side depends only on $\eta(\vec{u})$. For the second assertion choose child tuples with semilattice values y, y' and apply the same rule with the same sibling tuples. The two parent yields have identical η-values, hence identical quotient values by the first assertion. Linearity and nondeletion cancel all contributions except those of the varied child, proving the claimed equality. □

Lemma 4.22 (Height decrease at multivalued branching)**.** *For every child occurrence B_j in a rule with parent A, $\nu(B_j) \leq \nu(A)$. If a rule has at least two occurrences of multivalued children, then each such occurrence satisfies $\nu(B_j) < \nu(A)$. Every multivalued A has $\nu(A) \geq 1$.*

Proof. Complete a tuple from B_j realizing a maximum-height semilattice value by arbitrary productive sibling yields. The parent join is at least the child value, proving the nonstrict inequality. For strictness choose a multivalued child occurrence B_j and a value $y_* \in D_{B_j}$ with $\mathrm{ht}(y_*) = \nu(B_j)$. A different multivalued child occurrence B_k realizes two semilattice values z, z' with $F_{B_k}(z) \neq F_{B_k}(z')$.

They cannot both lie below y_*: fixing B_j at y_* would make $z \vee W = z' \vee W = W$ in the rectangle lemma, forcing their F_{B_k}-values to agree. At least one, say z, therefore satisfies $z \not\leq y_*$. Consequently $y_* < y_* \vee z$, and the parent admits a tuple whose semilattice value is at least $y_* \vee z$. Thus $\nu(A) > \nu(B_j)$. Finally, a multivalued symbol realizes at least two different semilattice values; at least one lies above $\bot$, giving $\nu(A) \geq 1$. □

Lemma 4.23 (Short representatives for each quotient value)**.** *Put $H_Y = \max_{y \in Y} \mathrm{ht}(y)$ and $b = \max\{0, H_Y - 1\}$. For every nonterminal A and $\alpha \in \pi\varphi(L_A)$ there is a generated tuple $\omega_A^\alpha \in L_A$ with quotient value α and*

$$\|\omega_A^\alpha\|_1 \leq B_\sharp := r^b |Y| (\|G\| + r|V| t_G) \leq C_{Y,r} \|G\| \max\{1, \theta_G\}.$$

Proof. If A is single-valued, take a shortest yield of length at most t_G. Otherwise choose, among derivations from A with the required quotient value, one minimizing (total yield length, number of derivation nodes) lexicographically. Every child subtree must also minimize this pair for its own nonterminal and quotient value: replacing it otherwise would give a smaller derivation of the same parent quotient value. In particular, a single-valued child can be replaced by a globally shortest yield of length at most t_G.

Prune all single-valued child subtrees, charging their terminal yields to their parent, and retain the tree of multivalued occurrences. Along any root-to-leaf path the pair (nonterminal, quotient value) cannot repeat: each selected subtree is lexicographically minimal for that pair, whereas a strict descendant has strictly fewer nodes and no greater yield length (by nondeletion). For each nonterminal there are at most $|Y|$ quotient values, so every retained path has at most $|V||Y|$ nodes.

Lemma 4.22 says that ν does not increase down a path, while a node with two or more retained children forces a strict decrease on each retained edge. All retained nodes have $\nu \geq 1$. Thus each path has at most b branching nodes, and the retained tree has at most r^b leaves (when no multivalued symbols exist the claim already follows from t_G).

Each leaf path contains at most $|V||Y|$ retained nodes, each with at most r pruned children of cost t_G. Hence the total cost of pruned children is at most $r^b r |V||Y| t_G$. For a retained node v let a_{R_v} be the number of explicit terminal symbols written by its rule. Each nonterminal A appears at most $|Y|$ times on any retained path, whence

$$\sum_{v \text{ on a path}} a_{R_v} \leq |Y| \sum_{A \in V} \max_{R:\, \mathrm{lhs}(R) = A} a_R \leq |Y| \|G\|.$$

Summing over at most r^b leaf paths may overcount but cannot omit any retained node. Combining the costs yields the displayed bound. The last inequality uses $t_G \leq \theta_G$ and $|V| \leq \|G\|$. □

Theorem 4.24 (Polynomial data for semilattice-indexed abelian cosets)**.** *Fix a nonempty finite alphabet Σ, finite typing $h : \Sigma^* \to M$, a finite join-semilattice Y, a morphism $\eta : \Sigma^* \to Y$ with $\eta \preceq h$, and $f, r \geq 1$. There exist constants C, C' depending only on Σ, h, Y, η, f, r such that, for every abelian group $\mathbb{A}$, morphism $\varphi : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{A}$, subgroup $\mathcal{H} \leq \mathbb{A}$, map $\gamma : Y \to \mathbb{A}$, and $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq M$, every reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r$ presentation G of the nonempty target (3) satisfies*

$$\kappa_G \leq C(\|G\| \bar{\theta}_G)^{3|\Sigma|+1}, \qquad \|K^\dagger\|_+ \leq C'(\|G\| \bar{\theta}_G)^{3|\Sigma|+2}, \quad \bar{\theta}_G = \max\{1, \theta_G\},$$

for some characteristic sample $K^\dagger \subseteq L$ of both $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}^{\leq r}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,h}$, with $|K^\dagger| \leq |V||M|^f + |P||M|^{fr}$.

Proof. As observed after (3), $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,h}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$. The language is saturated under joint equality of h-type and $\pi\varphi$-value, because $\eta \preceq h$. For a typed symbol $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$, all tuples in L_X have the same total η-value and hence the same quotient value by Lemma 4.21. Lemma 4.23 supplies assumption (iii) of Lemma 4.20 with $B = B_\sharp = O_{Y,r}(\|G\| \bar{\theta}_G)$. That lemma gives the claimed estimates. □

Corollary 4.25 (Abelian-filtered targets)**.** *Fix Σ, h, f, r as in the preceding theorem. For any abelian group $\mathbb{A}$, morphism $\varphi : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{A}$, subgroup $\mathcal{H} \leq \mathbb{A}$, $\gamma \in \mathbb{A}$, and $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq M$, put $L^+ = h^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \cap \varphi^{-1}(\gamma + \mathcal{H}) \cap \Sigma^+$. If L^+ has a reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r$ presentation G, then $L^+ \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$ and both reconstruction operators have a characteristic sample $K^\dagger \subseteq L^+$ with $\|K^\dagger\|_+ \leq C(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)^{3|\Sigma|+2}$, where C depends only on Σ, h, f, r, not on the auxiliary abelian data. If the full filtered target also contains ε, augment its characteristic sample by ε at encoded cost one.*

Proof. Take Y to be the one-element semilattice, let η be constant and $\gamma(\bot) = \gamma$ in Theorem 4.24. This specialization is available for *every* fixed finite typing h. In fact all untyped nonterminals are single-valued and one may take $B = t_G$ in Lemma 4.20. The empty word is treated separately by the existing start-symbol convention. □

Corollary 4.26 (One-marker split abelian targets)**.** *Fix a nonempty set of marker letters $\Sigma_{\mathsf{c}} \subseteq \Sigma$ and put $c(w) = 1$ if w contains a marker, $c(w) = 0$ otherwise. If the finite typing h refines $h_{\mathrm{U}} : w \mapsto c(w)$ into $(\{0,1\}, \max)$, then the preceding polynomial bounds hold for every reduced good bounded-rank presentation of $L = \{w \in \Sigma^+ : \varphi(w) \in \gamma_{c(w)} + \mathcal{H}\}$.*

Proof. Apply Theorem 4.24 with $Y = \{0,1\}$, $\eta = h_{\mathrm{U}}$ and $\mathsf{Acc} = M$. □

Remark 4.27. The semilattice-indexed result is a *target-language* criterion: it restricts the abelian-coset structure of the language and is uniform over its auxiliary abelian data. The local-group criterion in Appendix C instead restricts the *fixed typing* and applies to all targets in the corresponding typed substitutable class. Neither subsumes the other in general. The bounds above use relaxed distributional witnesses and are existential; the computable rule-only budget of Proposition 4.16 is distinct. The higher-fan-out superpolynomial characteristic-data lower-bound question remains open.

5 Comparison with Multidimensional Substitutability

Yoshinaka's multidimensional substitutability provides the untyped baseline [13, 14]. The trivial typing recovers it, whereas finite typing restricts which tuples may be identified.

Definition 5.1 (Yoshinaka multidimensional substitutability)**.** At arity $d \leq f$, a language is *fD-substitutable* when, for sentence contexts $E, F \in \mathcal{E}_d$ and nonempty-component tuples $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$, the implication $E[\vec{x}], E[\vec{y}], F[\vec{x}] \in L \Rightarrow F[\vec{y}] \in L$ holds. Write $\mathsf{YSub}(f)$ for this class. Yoshinaka requires nonempty internal context separators; empty separators and components belong to a stronger alternative condition [14, Section 3.1 and footnote 3].

For trivial typing, $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h_{\mathrm{triv}}} = \mathsf{YSub}(f) \cap f\text{-MCFL} \subseteq \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$. For $f = 1$, the $h^{k,\ell}_\Sigma$ guard is precisely Yoshinaka's (k, ℓ) prefix–suffix condition [12]; for higher fan-out it acts componentwise. The untyped setting already has polynomial time and witness-length guarantees at fixed dimension and rank [14, Theorem 1 and Lemma 7]. Our quantitative extension concerns the original thickness under finite typed multi-component control.

5.1 A genuine fan-out-two separation

The rank-one bound of Theorem 4.5 covers genuinely non-context-free targets. The following example also separates fixed typed substitutability from an untyped multidimensionally substitutable language followed by an arbitrary regular filter.

Following the standard local-testability terminology [26], call $L_{\mathrm{sl}} \subseteq \Sigma^*$ *strictly 2-local* if there is a set $\mathsf{Adj} \subseteq (\Sigma \cup \{\vdash, \dashv\})^2$ such that

$$w \in L_{\mathrm{sl}} \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \text{every adjacent pair in } \vdash w \dashv \text{ belongs to } \mathsf{Adj},$$

where $\vdash, \dashv \notin \Sigma$ are fixed boundary markers.

Lemma 5.2 (Strictly 2-local constraints are boundary typed)**.** *If $L_{\mathrm{sl}} \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is strictly 2-local, then for every $f \geq 1$, $L_{\mathrm{sl}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h^{1,1}_{\Sigma}}$.*

Proof. Let equal-$h^{1,1}_{\Sigma}$-type nonempty tuples $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ share an accepting context E_0. Internal adjacent pairs of each y_i are permitted because they occur in $E_0[\vec{y}]$. If $E[\vec{x}] \in L_{\mathrm{sl}}$, every adjacent pair of $E[\vec{y}]$ is either in fixed material, internal to a y_i, or crosses a component boundary. These are permitted respectively by $E[\vec{x}]$, by $E_0[\vec{y}]$, or by equality of the first/last letters encoded by the boundary type; end-marker pairs are unchanged. Thus $E[\vec{y}] \in L_{\mathrm{sl}}$, and symmetry finishes the proof. □

Arbitrary target-dependent regular filters. For comparison, on a fixed alphabet define

$$\mathcal{F}^{\mathrm{arb}}_f := \{L_0 \cap R : L_0 \in \mathsf{YSub}(f),\ R \text{ regular}\} \cap f\text{-MCFL}.$$

This class contains all regular languages (take $\Sigma^* \in \mathsf{YSub}(f)$) and is therefore not TxtEx-identifiable as a single positive-data class by Gold's obstruction. We use it only as an expressiveness baseline, not as an additional learnable class.

The next theorem shows that finite componentwise typing can express a non-context-free fan-out-two rank-one target outside this entire filtering baseline.

Theorem 5.3 (A fan-out-two typed language beyond arbitrary regular filtering)**.** *Let* $\Sigma_\star := \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}, \mathtt{d}\}$ *and*

$$L_\star := \{\mathtt{a}^n\mathtt{c}^{n+1}\mathtt{b}^n : n \geq 0\} \cup \{\mathtt{a}^n\mathtt{d}^{n+1}\mathtt{b}^{2n} : n \geq 0\}.$$

Let $g_\star : \Sigma_\star^* \to (\mathcal{P}(\{\mathtt{c}, \mathtt{d}\}), \cup)$ *be the homomorphism defined by*

$$g_\star(\mathtt{a}) = g_\star(\mathtt{b}) = \varnothing, \qquad g_\star(\mathtt{c}) = \{\mathtt{c}\}, \qquad g_\star(\mathtt{d}) = \{\mathtt{d}\},$$

and put $h_\star := (h^{1,1}_{\Sigma_\star}, g_\star)$*. Then $L_\star$ is non-context-free, has minimum fan-out two and minimum fan-out-two rule rank one, and for every $f \geq 2$, $L_\star \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h_\star} \setminus \mathcal{F}^{\mathrm{arb}}_f$. Equivalently, there are no $L_0 \in \mathsf{YSub}(f)$ and regular R_{reg} such that $L_\star = L_0 \cap R_{\mathrm{reg}}$.*

Proof. A good fan-out-two rank-one grammar is

$$\begin{aligned} A_{\mathtt{c}} &\to (\mathtt{ac}, \mathtt{b}) \mid (\mathtt{a}\xi^1_1\mathtt{c}, \xi^2_1\mathtt{b})(A_{\mathtt{c}}), \\ A_{\mathtt{d}} &\to (\mathtt{ad}, \mathtt{bb}) \mid (\mathtt{a}\xi^1_1\mathtt{d}, \xi^2_1\mathtt{bb})(A_{\mathtt{d}}), \\ S &\to \mathtt{c} \mid \mathtt{d} \mid (\xi^1_1\mathtt{c}\xi^2_1)(A_{\mathtt{c}}) \mid (\xi^1_1\mathtt{d}\xi^2_1)(A_{\mathtt{d}}). \end{aligned}$$

It generates exactly $L_\star$. The intersection with the regular language $\mathtt{a}^*\mathtt{c}^+\mathtt{b}^*$ is $\{\mathtt{a}^n\mathtt{c}^{n+1}\mathtt{b}^n : n \geq 0\}$, which is not context-free. For a short closure proof, introduce a fresh symbol # and the homomorphism fixing $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}$ and sending # to $\mathtt{c}$. The inverse image of this branch, intersected with $\mathtt{a}^*\mathtt{c}^*\#\mathtt{b}^*$, is $\{\mathtt{a}^n\mathtt{c}^n\#\mathtt{b}^n : n \geq 0\}$; erasing # would make $\{\mathtt{a}^n\mathtt{c}^n\mathtt{b}^n : n \geq 0\}$ context-free, a contradiction. Thus the minimum fan-out is two, and infinitude together with the displayed grammar gives minimum fan-out-two rule rank one.

For typed substitutability put

$$Q_\star := \mathtt{a}^*\mathtt{c}^+\mathtt{b}^* \cup \mathtt{a}^*\mathtt{d}^+\mathtt{b}^*, \qquad \Psi(w) := (|w|_\mathtt{a}, |w|_\mathtt{b}, |w|_\mathtt{c}, |w|_\mathtt{d}).$$

The strictly 2-local language $Q_\star$ is boundary typed by Lemma 5.2. Let equal-$h_\star$-type tuples $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ share an accepting context E_0, and set $\Delta := \sum_i \Psi(y_i) - \sum_i \Psi(x_i)$. Their equal $g_\star$-types put $E_0[\vec{x}], E_0[\vec{y}]$ on the same branch, so for some $q \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\Delta = q(1,1,1,0)$ or $\Delta = q(1,2,0,1)$ according as that branch is $\mathtt{c}$ or $\mathtt{d}$.

If $F[\vec{x}] \in L_\star$, boundary typing gives $F[\vec{y}] \in Q_\star$, and equal $g_\star$-types put the two fillings on the same F-branch. When E_0 and F choose the same branch, the displayed count difference preserves its affine relation. If they choose different branches, no tuple component can contain $\mathtt{c}$ or $\mathtt{d}$; hence the two center coordinates of Δ vanish, forcing $q = 0$. In either case $F[\vec{y}] \in L_\star$, and symmetry proves $L_\star \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h_\star}$.

Finally assume $L_\star = L_0 \cap R_{\mathrm{reg}}$ with $L_0 \in \mathsf{YSub}(f)$ and R_{reg} regular. Since $\mathtt{c}, \mathtt{d} \in L_0$, arity-one substitutability gives $\mathcal{D}_{L_0}(\mathtt{c}) = \mathcal{D}_{L_0}(\mathtt{d})$. Hence, replacing the two occurrences of $\mathtt{d}$ successively, $\mathtt{ad}^2\mathtt{b}^2 \in L_0$ yields first $\mathtt{acdb}^2 \in L_0$ and then $\mathtt{ac}^2\mathtt{b}^2 \in L_0$; together with $\mathtt{ac}^2\mathtt{b} \in L_0$ gives $\mathcal{D}_{L_0}(\mathtt{c}^2\mathtt{b}) = \mathcal{D}_{L_0}(\mathtt{c}^2\mathtt{b}^2)$. Thus $\mathtt{a}^m\mathtt{c}^{m+1}\mathtt{b}^{m+t} \in L_0$ for all $m \geq 1, t \geq 0$. For m at least the state number of a DFA for R_{reg}, pumping the final $\mathtt{b}^m$ block of the accepted target word gives some $t > 0$ with the same word in R_{reg}, hence in the intersection but not in $L_\star$, a contradiction. □

This witness has minimum fan-out two and rank one. Thus the grammar-size polynomial characteristic-data result of Theorem 4.5 is not merely a restatement of a context-free or linear-CFG special case. Moreover, the semilattice projection of the positive image of $h_\star$ is the full four-element union semilattice $\mathcal{P}(\{\mathtt{c}, \mathtt{d}\})$: the letters $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}, \mathtt{d}$ realize its bottom and singleton generators. Since **LG** is closed under homomorphic images but this semilattice contains U_1, $h_\star(\Sigma_\star^+) \notin \mathbf{LG}$. Thus the rank-one polynomial-data bound applies even when the local-group typing condition fails.

6 Conclusion

Fixed finite-monoid typing permits exact positive-data reconstruction and conservative TxtEx learning; at bounded rank, hypothesis updates are polynomial in the observed data. The quantitative results give polynomial characteristic length from either local-group structure of the fixed typing (Theorem 4.10) or semilattice-indexed abelian-coset structure of the target (Theorem 4.24). Window and rank-one bounds are useful special cases; Theorem 5.3 supplies a non-context-free fan-out-two rank-one separation beyond regular filtering. The computable rule-only and existential distributional-witness bounds remain distinct. Full yield-type refinement and empty-component elimination may increase thickness exponentially (Appendix A).

Open Problem 6.1 (Original-thickness bounds beyond fan-out one). Fix $f \geq 2$ and a rule-rank bound $r \geq 2$. Does there exist a fixed finite typing h and a family of reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r$ grammars G_n of targets in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$ for which $\|G_n\| \max\{1, \theta_{G_n}\}$ grows polynomially in n but every characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r}_{f,h}$ has superpolynomial total positive length? The fan-out-one counterexample of the companion CFG paper [25] does not by itself answer this higher-arity question: membership in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,h}$ need not imply membership in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,h}$ for $f \geq 2$.

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Data availability

No empirical datasets were used. The source manuscript and scripts for reproducing finite illustrative checks are available in the public repository https://github.com/growupkuriyama-hub/Papers/tree/main/02_fixed-h-mcfg. The general theorems are supported by mathematical proofs in this article, not by exhaustive computational testing.

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in the manuscript preparation process

The author used ChatGPT (OpenAI) and Claude (Anthropic) during the research and manuscript-preparation process, including exploratory mathematical argument development, proof drafting and criticism, literature and consistency checks, and editing of text and LaTeX source. AI-generated suggestions and reviews are not treated as independent mathematical verification. The author takes responsibility for the mathematical claims, citations, and final content of this article.

A Details of the Good Normalization

The following bookkeeping records the fixed-parameter bounds used in Proposition 2.8; semantic correctness of the nondeleting and nonmerging conversions is standard [14, 30, 32].

Nondeleting conversion and component permutations. After trimming, use only the nondeleting step (f3) from the proof of Seki et al.'s Lemma 2.2, in Kanazawa's rank-preserving form [30, proof of Lemma 2.2, item (f3)] [32, Section 2.1]. Retained-component subsets give at most $O_f(1)$ decorated copies per nonterminal and $O_{f,r_{\max}}(1)$ projected copies per rule; deleting an empty child cannot increase rank. For nonpermutation, decorate a fan-out-d nonterminal by $\sigma \in \mathfrak{S}_d$. The parent permutation determines the child permutations, so there are at most $f!$ copies, no child is duplicated, and rank is preserved. Denote the result by G_{nd}.

Removing empty tuple components. For a fan-out-d nonterminal A, let

$$\mathsf{Pat}(A) := \{I \subseteq \{1, \dots, d\} : I \text{ is the nonempty-component pattern of some } \vec{w} \in L_A(G_{\mathrm{nd}})\}.$$

Finite saturation computes these sets. For realizable child patterns, replace variables from absent components by ε, delete empty parent components, and omit all-empty children. There are at most 2^f patterns per nonterminal and $2^{f r_{\max}}$ choices per rule. Introduce A^I for each nonempty pattern I.

Retained variables still occur once and in order, so nondeletion/nonpermutation, fan-out, and rank are preserved and the result is λ-free.

Induction on derivations gives L_{A^I} exactly as the projection of source tuples having pattern I; all-empty omitted children can be restored by terminal derivations realizing their all-empty component pattern. Since the start symbol has fan-out one, $S^{\{1\}}$ generates precisely the nonempty part of the original language. Projection shortens templates, giving $O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{nd}}\|)$ size.

Nonmerging. Apply Yoshinaka's nonmerging conversion [14, Section 2.3, Lemma 1]. Each decorated nonterminal denotes exactly the projected tuples associated with its retained component pattern, and adjacent-component concatenation preserves λ-freeness, nonpermutation, fan-out, and rule rank. For fixed fan-out and rank Yoshinaka's combined good-form conversion has $O(\|G\|)$ size [14, Section 2.3, after Example 2]; trimming can only decrease all bounds. This proves Proposition 2.8.

Thickness transfer for λ-free presentations

Proposition A.1 (Thickness under good-form conversion)**.** *Fix f and $r_{\max}$. Let G_{in} be a reduced λ-free f-MCFG of maximum rule rank at most $r_{\max}$, possibly with deleting rules, and suppose $L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \cap \Sigma^+ \neq \emptyset$. The good normalization of Proposition 2.8 yields an equivalent reduced good grammar G with the same fan-out and rule-rank bounds such that*

$$\|G\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|), \qquad t_G \leq t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}, \qquad \theta_G = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\| \max\{1, t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}\}).$$

Proof. For λ-free G_{in}, every derived component is nonempty. The nondeleting conversion therefore needs no later empty-pattern split, and each retained decoration A^I generates exactly the projection of $L_A(G_{\mathrm{in}})$ onto I. Hence its minimum total yield cannot exceed that of A. Component permutations preserve total length, and Yoshinaka's nonmerging copies are exact adjacent-component images [14, Section 2.3, Lemma 1], so $t_G \leq t_{G_{\mathrm{in}}}$. All decorations have fixed-parameter linear overhead, giving $\|G\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$; then Lemma 4.1 yields the displayed bound on θ_G. □

Thus deleting rules do not by themselves obstruct polynomial thickness transfer from a reduced λ-free presentation; genuine empty components are the problematic step.

Proposition A.2 (Empty-component elimination can blow up thickness)**.** *For every $n \geq 1$ there is a reduced fan-out-two, rule-rank-two MCFG E_n of size $O(n)$ with $t_{E_n} \leq 2$ and $\theta_{E_n} = O(n)$ such that the empty-component elimination stage of Proposition 2.8 contains a retained nonterminal and a retained rule of thickness at least 2^n.*

Proof. Let E_n have fan-out-one S, fan-out-two $A_0, \ldots, A_n$, and

$$\begin{aligned} A_0 &\to (\mathtt{a}, \varepsilon), \\ A_i &\to (\varepsilon, \mathtt{c}) \mid (\xi_1^1\xi_2^1, \xi_1^2\xi_2^2)(A_{i-1}, A_{i-1}) \quad (1 \leq i \leq n), \\ S &\to (\xi_1^1 \mathtt{d}\, \xi_1^2)(A_n). \end{aligned}$$

It is reduced, nondeleting, nonpermuting, and nonmerging. Short side derivations give $t_{E_n} \leq 2$, and placing any chosen rule on one branch of the binary spine while completing siblings minimally gives $\theta_{E_n} = O(n)$.

If an A_i-tuple has nonempty first component and empty second component, the rule $(\varepsilon, \mathtt{c})$ cannot occur. Inductively the shortest such tuple is $(\mathtt{a}^{2^i}, \varepsilon)$. Thus pattern $\{1\}$ for A_n survives empty-component elimination, and the projected start rule $S \to \xi_1^1 \mathtt{d}\, (A_n^{\{1\}})$ can succeed only with a child of length at least 2^n. Hence the retained nonterminal and rule have thickness at least 2^n. □

This is the same obstruction exhibited by Proposition 4.4: finite state refinement can force exponentially long shortest witnesses inside one refined state.

B Finite-group order homogenization for local-group shortening

The following finite-group combinatorial lemmas control simultaneous replacement of interleaved blocks, without commutativity. They are used in the local-group shortening argument of Lemma C.7. The separate window–group polynomial-data theorem is subsumed by Theorem 4.10.

Lemma B.1 (A homogeneous block-order lemma)**.** *Fix positive integers e, n with $n \geq 3$. For each $t \in [e]$ and $i \in [n]$, let (t, i) be a distinct point on a line, with a total left-to-right order. Suppose that (i) the order of (t, i) and (u, i) is independent of i; and (ii) for each ordered pair (t, u), including $t = u$, the order of (t, i) and (u, j) for $i < j$ is independent of the choice of $i < j$. Then the types at the points have a partition into classes, each occupying a consecutive region of the line. Every class has one direction (increasing or decreasing in i); inside its region the points occur in n successive* chunks*, one per rank in that direction. Each chunk consists of exactly one point of each type in the class (in a fixed within-chunk order).*

Proof. By (ii) with $t = u$, each type's points are monotone. Consider distinct types t, u. Write X for $(t, i) < (u, j)$ when $i < j$, and Y for $(u, i) < (t, j)$ when $i < j$; both are uniform by (ii). If both types increase, $X \wedge Y$ puts all points of rank i before all points of rank $j > i$. The cases $X \wedge \neg Y$ and $\neg X \wedge Y$ put all t-points before all u-points, or conversely. The remaining case $\neg X \wedge \neg Y$ would give $(t, 1) < (t, 2) < (u, 1) < (u, 2) < (t, 1)$, a contradiction. If t increases and u decreases, $X \wedge Y$ gives $(t, 2) < (u, 3) < (u, 1) < (t, 2)$, while $\neg X \wedge \neg Y$ gives $(t, 3) < (u, 2) < (t, 1) < (t, 3)$. For $X \wedge \neg Y$, all off-diagonal comparisons put t to the left of u; a contrary equal-rank comparison would give $(t, 1) < (u, 2) < (u, 1) < (t, 1)$, contrary to (i). Thus the types are separated. The case $\neg X \wedge Y$ is symmetric. Reverse indices to cover the two-decreasing case. Thus any two types are either *separated*, or have the same direction and are *interleaved by rank*.

Interleaving is transitive. Indeed, if t interleaves with u and u with v, all three have the same direction. Reverse indices to assume increasing. If t and v were separated with t to the left, we would have $(v, 1) < (u, 2) < (t, 3) < (v, 1)$; if v were to the left of t, we would instead have $(t, 1) < (u, 2) < (v, 3) < (t, 1)$. Hence interleaving, with equality, partitions the types into classes. A type outside a class is separated from each type inside it, and must lie on the same side of all its types: otherwise two interleaved types would themselves be separated. The class regions are therefore consecutive. The rank comparisons give successive chunks. Finally the within-chunk order is independent of rank by (i). □

Lemma B.2 (Simultaneous finite-group interval shortening)**.** *Let A be any finite group. Suppose n indices each contribute at most f disjoint blocks to at most f ordered output components, and each block has a prescribed replacement block. A selected index replaces* all *its blocks simultaneously. The other material is fixed. If the individual block destinations and within-index orders are constant across the indices, and all cross-index block order comparisons are constant for $i < j$, then $n \geq \max\{3, |A|^f\}$ implies that a nonempty consecutive interval of indices can be replaced without changing any output component's value in A.*

Proof. Apply Lemma B.1 separately to the block types going to each output component. Across all output components there are $q \leq f$ consecutive class regions. Consider such a region K, and enumerate its chunks $1, \ldots, n$ from left to right. Include all unchanged material between the blocks

in the region. Let P_p be the original group value of its prefix ending after chunk p, and Q_p the value of the same prefix when chunks $1, \dots, p$ have been replaced; set $P_0 = Q_0 = 1_A$. Write $\kappa_p^K = P_p Q_p^{-1}$.

Replacing just chunks $p+1, \dots, p'$ gives the following *ordered* value for the entire region: $P_p\, Q_p^{-1} Q_{p'}\, P_{p'}^{-1} P_n$. Indeed, $Q_p^{-1} Q_{p'}$ is exactly the replacement value of the segment between the two prefix boundaries, and $P_{p'}^{-1} P_n$ is its unchanged suffix. Consequently, the region retains its original value P_n whenever $\kappa_p^K = \kappa_{p'}^K$. This computation uses inverses, but never commutes factors.

If class K increases with the original index order, its chunks for indices $(a, b]$ occupy $(a, b]$. If it decreases, they occupy $(n-b, n-a]$. For $j = 0, \dots, n$ define a state in A^q by taking κ_j^K from each increasing class and κ_{n-j}^K from each decreasing class. There are $n+1 > |A|^q$ such states, so two, at indices $a < b$, coincide. Replacing precisely indices $a+1, \dots, b$ then preserves each class region's value. The rest of every output component is unchanged, so all output group values are preserved. □

Lemma B.3 (Ordered-product interval shortening)**.** *Let A be a finite group. Consider at most f ordered lines of* slots*. A fixed slot carries an element of A, while a block slot (t, i) carries an original value $o_{t,i} \in A$ and a replacement value $r_{t,i} \in A$, with t from at most f block types and $i \in [n]$. Every (t, i) occurs once, all slots of a given type lie on one line, and each index is replaced in all its block slots simultaneously. Suppose the block-slot positions on each line satisfy the two order-uniformity hypotheses of Lemma B.1. If $n \geq \max\{3, |A|^f\}$, some nonempty interval of indices can be replaced while preserving the ordered product on every line.*

Proof. The block-order lemma divides the block slots of each line into consecutive class regions, each comprising n equal-order chunks in increasing or decreasing index order. Include fixed slots between consecutive blocks in the adjacent regions; fixed slots outside the regions remain unchanged. There are at most $q \leq f$ regions in total. For one region let P_p be the original product through chunk p, and let Q_p be the product through chunk p when the first p chunks have been replaced; put $P_0 = Q_0 = 1_A$. Replacement of just chunks $(p, p']$ produces the ordered value $P_p Q_p^{-1} Q_{p'} P_{p'}^{-1} P_n$. Thus the original value P_n is preserved whenever $P_p Q_p^{-1} = P_{p'} Q_{p'}^{-1}$. No factors are commuted. For $j = 0, \dots, n$, record $P_j Q_j^{-1}$ from increasing regions and $P_{n-j} Q_{n-j}^{-1}$ from decreasing regions in one state of A^q. Since $n+1 > |A|^q$, two states indexed $a < b$ coincide. Switching precisely indices $(a, b]$ preserves all region products, and all remaining fixed slots are unchanged. □

Lemma B.4 (Polynomial order homogenization)**.** *Let $N \geq 3$, and define $m_0 = N$ and $m_{s+1} = (m_s - 1)^2 + 1$, so that $m_k \leq N^{2^k}$. Let T be a finite set of point types, each assigned to one of several lines. For every index $i \in [n]$ and $t \in T$ let $p_t(i)$ be a point on the line of t, the points on each line being distinct. Let Π be the set of ordered pairs (t, u), including $t = u$, of types on a common line, and put $k = |\Pi|$. If $n \geq m_k$, there is a set $I \subseteq [n]$ of N indices such that, for every $(t, u) \in \Pi$, the truth value of $p_t(i) < p_u(j)$ is the same for all $i < j$ in I.*

Proof. Treat the pairs one at a time, the pairs (t, t) first. Each step passes from a current index set of size at least $(m-1)^2 + 1$ to a subset of size at least m. Homogeneity already obtained, and monotonicity of each type, persist in subsets.

For (t, t), homogeneity means that p_t is monotone on the subset. The Erdős–Szekeres theorem gives a monotone subsequence of length m.

For $t \neq u$, both p_t and p_u are already monotone. Relabel the current indices $1, \dots, m'$ in order, with $m' \geq (m-1)^2 + 1$. For $i < j$ put $X(i, j) = [p_t(i) < p_u(j)]$. Each row $X(i, \cdot)$ is monotone in j, and each column $X(\cdot, j)$ is monotone in i. Replacing X by $1 - X$ if necessary, we may assume that the rows go from 0 to 1. This does not change which sets are homogeneous.

If the columns go from 1 to 0, put $J(i) = \min\{j > i : X(i,j) = 1\}$, or $J(i) = \infty$ if there is no such j. Then J is nondecreasing. Set $i_1 = 1$ and $i_{s+1} = J(i_s)$ while this is at most m'. For $a < b$ we have $i_b \geq J(i_a)$, so $X(i_a, i_b) = 1$. If the chain has at least m terms, its first m terms suffice. If it has fewer than m terms, its at most $m-1$ terms cut $[m']$ into at most $m-1$ intervals $[i_s, i_{s+1})$ and $[i_L, m']$, and one interval has at least $m'/(m-1) > m-1$ indices. Inside $[i_s, i_{s+1})$, every $i < j$ satisfies $j < i_{s+1} = J(i_s) \leq J(i)$, so $X(i,j) = 0$. The same holds in the last interval, where $J \equiv \infty$.

If the columns go from 0 to 1, the set of pairs with $X = 1$ is closed upward in both coordinates. Let κ be the least index with $X(\kappa, \kappa+1) = 1$, or $\kappa = m'$ if there is none. For $\kappa \leq i < j$ we have $X(i,j) \geq X(\kappa, \kappa+1) = 1$. For $i < j \leq \kappa$ we have $X(i,j) \leq X(j-1, j) = 0$. One of $[1, \kappa]$ and $[\kappa, m']$ has at least $(m'+1)/2 \geq m$ indices, because $(m-1)^2 + 1 \geq 2m - 1$ for $m \geq 3$.

After all k pairs the remaining set has at least $m_0 = N$ indices. Finally, $m_{s+1} \leq m_s^2$ gives $m_k \leq N^{2^k}$. □

Lemma B.5 (Uniform shortening of heavy antichains)**.** *Set* $N_{A,f} = \max\{3, |A|^f\}$, $U_f = f^{f+1} f!$, $M_{A,f} = U_f\, N_{A,f}^{2^{f^2}}$. *Let G be reduced and good, and let $g : \Sigma^* \to A$ be any homomorphism into a finite group. Consider a terminal derivation from a fixed nonterminal that minimizes first total yield length and then node count among derivations with a prescribed componentwise root g-value. Every antichain of nodes* each *of whose subtree yields has total length $> \bar{\theta}_G$ has fewer than $M_{A,f}$ members.*

Proof. Every child component passes through the linear, nondeleting templates to exactly one contiguous block in a root component. Blocks of incomparable subtrees are disjoint. Fix for each node of a heavy antichain a replacement derivation of the *same untyped* nonterminal whose yield has length at most $\bar{\theta}_G$; such a derivation exists by Lemma 4.6(ii). Its group values may differ from the original values.

An antichain node has at most f blocks. Its *unary pattern* records the number of blocks, their root-component destinations, and their order within any shared root component. There are at most U_f such patterns. An antichain of at least $M_{A,f}$ nodes therefore contains at least $N_{A,f}^{2^{f^2}}$ nodes with one common unary pattern. Enumerate them in any fixed order. The block types of the common pattern are points of at most f types, placed on the root components as lines. There are at most f^2 ordered pairs of types sharing a root component, including $t = u$. Since $m_k \leq N^{2^k} \leq N^{2^{f^2}}$ for $k \leq f^2$, Lemma B.4 yields $N = N_{A,f}$ indices with constant unary pattern and constant cross-index comparisons between (t,i) and (u,j) for all $i < j$.

Within each root component their blocks meet the hypotheses of Lemma B.1. Lemma B.2 therefore supplies a nonempty interval of these selected indices whose simultaneous replacement preserves the *whole root group vector*. Every replaced subtree was heavy but is replaced by one of length at most $\bar{\theta}_G$, so the resulting valid derivation has strictly smaller root yield length. This contradicts its choice. □

C Local-group typings and the semilattice boundary

Window–group typings have positive images in the pseudovariety join $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{G}$ of finite locally trivial semigroups and finite groups [25, Lemma 7.4]. Here we extend the polynomial original-thickness bound to the strictly larger pseudovariety $\mathbf{LG}$ of *local groups*. This is the class of finite semigroups S in which every local monoid eSe, with e idempotent, is a group. Classically, $\mathbf{LG} = \mathbf{G} * \mathbf{D}$ [38, 39]. The equivalence between being a local group, having a nilpotent extension of the minimal ideal, and containing no two-element semilattice is *known* [37, Proposition 2.3]. Theorem C.4 recalls this

equivalence. Its sliding-factor formulation is a concrete quantitative version of the classical $\mathbf{G} * \mathbf{D}$ window construction [38,39]; we give a self-contained proof with an explicit window $k = |S|$ because it is used in the MCFG length estimate. In particular, $\mathbf{LG}$ is exactly the class of finite semigroups containing no copy of the two-element semilattice $U_1 = \{1, \zeta\}$ ($\zeta^2 = \zeta$). That semilattice is the positive image of the typing behind the exponential lower bound of [25]. The companion CFG lower bound has this semilattice as its positive-image typing; a higher-fan-out converse is not asserted.

Throughout this appendix Σ is nonempty, $k \geq 1$, and A is a finite group. For a word w with $|w| \geq k+1$ let $\sigma_k(w)$ be the sequence of its factors of length $k+1$, ordered by their starting positions.

Definition C.1 (Local-group typing)**.** Let $g : \Sigma^{k+1} \to A$ be any map. For $|w| \geq 2k$ put

$$\gamma_{k,g}(w) := g(F_1)g(F_2)\cdots g(F_{|w|-k}), \qquad \sigma_k(w) = (F_1, \ldots, F_{|w|-k}),$$

the ordered product in A, and put $\gamma_{k,g}(w) := 1_A$ for $|w| < 2k$. The *local-group typing* is $\lambda_{k,g}(w) := (h_\Sigma^{k,k}(w), \gamma_{k,g}(w))$. A finite typing h is *local-group-determined* if $h \preceq \lambda_{k,g}$ for some k, A and g.

Recall from Definition 2.6 that, for $\ell = k$, words of length $< 2k$ are *short* and recorded exactly, while a *long* word w is recorded by $\langle \mathrm{pref}_k(w), \mathrm{suf}_k(w)\rangle$. For $s, p \in \Sigma^k$ write $J_g(s,p) := \prod_{i=1}^{k} g((sp)[i..i+k])$. This is the ordered product over the k factors of length $k+1$ of sp that start in s.

Lemma C.2 (Local-group typings are morphisms)**.** *The kernel of $\lambda_{k,g}$ is a congruence of finite index on Σ^*. Hence $\lambda_{k,g}$ is a homomorphism onto a finite monoid $M_{k,g}$. For long u, v,*

$$\lambda_{k,g}(uv) = \big(\langle \mathrm{pref}_k u, \mathrm{suf}_k v\rangle,\ \gamma_{k,g}(u)\, J_g(\mathrm{suf}_k u, \mathrm{pref}_k v)\, \gamma_{k,g}(v)\big).$$

Proof. The window component is a morphism by Definition 2.6. For long u, v, the factors of length $k+1$ of uv are, in order: those of u, then the k factors starting in the last k positions of u, then those of v. The middle factors lie inside $\mathrm{suf}_k(u)\,\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$, which gives the displayed formula.

If u is short and v is long, the factors of uv that start in u lie inside $u\,\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$, and the remaining factors are those of v. Thus $\gamma_{k,g}(uv)$ is determined by u, $\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$ and $\gamma_{k,g}(v)$. The case of long u and short v is symmetric. If both are short, uv is determined exactly.

In every case $\lambda_{k,g}(uv)$ is a function of $\lambda_{k,g}(u)$ and $\lambda_{k,g}(v)$. The image has at most $|\Sigma|^{<2k} + |\Sigma|^{2k}|A|$ elements. □

Lemma C.3 (Block decomposition)**.** *Let $w = x_0\beta_1 x_1 \cdots \beta_q x_q$ be a factorization of a word into designated blocks β_j and fixed words x_j. Let $w' = x_0\beta'_1 x_1 \cdots \beta'_q x_q$, where $h_\Sigma^{k,k}(\beta'_j) = h_\Sigma^{k,k}(\beta_j)$ for every j. Then $h_\Sigma^{k,k}(w') = h_\Sigma^{k,k}(w)$. If w is long, there are $c_0, \ldots, c_q \in A$, depending only on the x_j and the window types of the β_j, such that*

$$\gamma_{k,g}(w) = c_0\,\gamma_{k,g}(\beta_1)\,c_1 \cdots \gamma_{k,g}(\beta_q)\,c_q, \qquad \gamma_{k,g}(w') = c_0\,\gamma_{k,g}(\beta'_1)\,c_1 \cdots \gamma_{k,g}(\beta'_q)\,c_q.$$

Moreover, for every *simultaneous choice $\beta_j^{(\epsilon_j)}$ ($\epsilon_j \in \{0,1\}$) with $\beta_j^{(0)} = \beta_j$ and $h_\Sigma^{k,k}(\beta_j^{(1)}) = h_\Sigma^{k,k}(\beta_j)$, the same constants $c_0, \ldots, c_q$ work in the displayed formula. The whole-word window type is unchanged. A short designated block cannot change, and if the whole word is short, none of its designated blocks can change.*

Proof. A short block is recorded exactly, so $\beta'_j = \beta_j$; absorb such blocks into the fixed words. Every remaining block is long, and its replacement is long with the same first and last k letters. Hence w' is long exactly when w is, and its first and last k letters are unchanged. This gives the window claim.

Classify the factors F of length $k+1$ of w. If F lies inside a long block β_j, it is one of the factors of β_j. Otherwise F meets each long block it touches only in a prefix of length at most k or a suffix of length at most k. If it met both ends of β_j, then $|\beta_j| \le k-1$, so β_j would be short. Hence every factor of the second kind is spelled by the fixed words and the windows $\mathrm{pref}_k(\beta_j)$, $\mathrm{suf}_k(\beta_j)$. The same factors, in the same order, occur in w'. Ordering all factors by starting position, the factors inside β_j form one consecutive run contributing $\gamma_{k,g}(\beta_j)$. Let c_j be the ordered product of the remaining factors between the runs of β_j and β_{j+1}.

The unchanged window type of each block fixes every cross-boundary factor, independently of the choice of the other replacements. Consequently the constants are uniform over all 2^q choices. Short blocks are recorded exactly; a short whole word consists only of fixed material and such unchanged blocks. □

Theorem C.4 (Characterizations of local-group positive images)**.** *For a finite typing $h : \Sigma^* \to M$ put $S := h(\Sigma^+)$. The following are equivalent.*

(i) *$S \in \mathbf{LG}$; that is, eSe is a group for every idempotent e of S.*

(ii) *S has no subsemigroup isomorphic to U_1.*

(iii) *Every idempotent of S lies in the minimal ideal of S.*

(iv) *h is local-group-determined. One may take $k = |S|$.*

Proof. The implications among (i)–(iii) follow from the standard characterization [37, Proposition 2.3]; we include their short semigroup argument to make the reduction self-contained. The additional equivalence with (iv) is the windowed-factor formulation required for learning.

(i)⇒(ii). Let $\{e, f\} \cong U_1$ with $ef = fe = f \neq e$. Then $f \in eSe$ is an idempotent of a group whose identity is e, so $f = e$, a contradiction.

(ii)⇒(iii). Let K be the minimal ideal of S; it contains an idempotent. For an idempotent e of S choose $s \in K$, and let $x := (ese)^\omega$. This is an idempotent in $K \cap eSe$, so $ex = xe = x$. If $x \neq e$ then $\{e, x\} \cong U_1$. Hence $e = x \in K$.

(iii)⇒(i). The minimal ideal K of a finite semigroup is completely simple [40]. For an idempotent $e \in K$ we have $eSe \subseteq K$, so $eSe = eKe$. In a completely simple semigroup this is the $\mathcal{H}$-class of e, a group.

(iii)⇒(iv). By the Rees theorem [40] write $K = \mathcal{M}(H; I, \Lambda; P)$, with product $(i, a, \lambda)(j, b, \mu) = (i, ap_{\lambda j}b, \mu)$. Put $n := |S|$.

Long products lie in K. The Rees quotient S/K has no idempotent other than 0, since all idempotents of S lie in K. Let $s_1, \dots, s_m \in S$ with $m := |S/K| \le n$, and consider the prefix products in S/K. If none is 0, two of them coincide, say $p_i = p_j$ with $i < j$. Then $p_i = p_i x = p_i x^\omega = 0$ for $x = s_{i+1} \cdots s_j$, a contradiction. Hence $h(w) \in K$ whenever $|w| \ge n$.

Right action. Fix $i_0 \in I$ and for $\lambda \in \Lambda$ let $e_\lambda := (i_0, p^{-1}_{\lambda i_0}, \lambda)$, an idempotent. For $x = (i, a, \lambda) \in K$ we have $xe_\lambda = x$. Hence, for $s \in S$, $xs = x(e_\lambda s)$. Writing $e_\lambda s = (j, c, \mu) \in K$ gives

$$(i, a, \lambda)\, s = (i,\ a\,\rho(\lambda, s),\ \mu(\lambda, s)), \qquad \rho(\lambda, s) := p_{\lambda j} c,$$

where $\rho(\lambda, s) \in H$ and $\mu(\lambda, s) \in \Lambda$ depend only on (λ, s). Dually, the Λ-coordinate of $h(w)$ for $|w| \ge n$ is that of $h(\mathrm{suf}_n w)$, and the I-coordinate is that of $h(\mathrm{pref}_n w)$.

Window factorization. Let $w = a_1 \cdots a_m$ with $m \ge 2n$, and let λ_j be the Λ-coordinate of $h(a_{j-n+1} \cdots a_j)$ for $j \ge n$. Iterating the right action gives

$$h(w) = \Big(i,\ a \prod_{j=n}^{m-1} \rho(\lambda_j, h(a_{j+1})),\ \lambda_m\Big), \qquad h(a_1 \cdots a_n) = (i, a, \lambda_n).$$

The j-th factor of the product depends only on the factor $a_{j-n+1}\cdots a_{j+1}$ of length $n+1$. Define $g(F) := \rho(\lambda(h(F[1..n])), h(F[n+1]))$ for $F \in \Sigma^{n+1}$. Then the product is $\gamma_{n,g}(w)$. So $h(w)$ is determined by $\mathrm{pref}_n w$, $\mathrm{suf}_n w$ and $\gamma_{n,g}(w)$. Words of length $< 2n$ are recorded exactly by $h_\Sigma^{n,n}$, and ε is the only word of its $\lambda_{n,g}$-class. Thus $h \preceq \lambda_{n,g}$ with $A = H$.

(iv)⇒(i). **LG** is closed under homomorphic images, so it suffices to show $T := \lambda_{k,g}(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LG}$. A short element is never idempotent: the square of a short word is either longer and short, or long. Let $e = (\langle p, s\rangle, \gamma_e)$ be an idempotent. By Lemma C.2, $\gamma_e J_g(s,p)\gamma_e = \gamma_e$. For every $x \in T$, exe has window $\langle p, s\rangle$, because e is long on both sides. Hence eTe lies in $H_e := \{(\langle p, s\rangle, \alpha) : \alpha \in A\}$. The product on H_e is $\alpha * \beta = \alpha J_g(s,p)\beta$. The map $\alpha \mapsto \alpha J_g(s,p)$ is an isomorphism from $(H_e, *)$ onto A. Thus eTe is a subsemigroup of a finite group, hence a group. □

Proposition C.5 (Window–group typings are local-group typings, strictly)**.** (i) *If $h \preceq (h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}, g)$ for a homomorphism g into a finite group, then $h \preceq \lambda_{K,g'}$ with $K = \max\{k,\ell,1\}$ and $g'(F) := g(\text{last letter of } F)$. Hence* $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{G} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$.

(ii) *Let $\Sigma = \{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b},\mathtt{c}\}$. Let $h_{\mathtt{ab}} := \lambda_{1,g}$ with $g(\mathtt{ab}) = 1 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$ and $g(F) = 0$ otherwise; it records the parity of the number of occurrences of $\mathtt{ab}$, together with the window. Then $h_{\mathtt{ab}}$ is not window–group-determined. Hence $h_{\mathtt{ab}}(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LG} \setminus (\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{G})$.*

Proof. (i) For $|w| \geq 2K$, $g(w) = g(\mathrm{pref}_K w)\,\gamma_{K,g'}(w)$. Shorter words are recorded exactly. Independently of the window construction, $\mathbf{LI} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$ (since $eSe = \{e\}$ there) and $\mathbf{G} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$. As **LG** is a pseudovariety, $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{G} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$.

(ii) Suppose $h_{\mathtt{ab}} \preceq (h_\Sigma^{k,\ell}, g')$ with $g' : \Sigma^* \to A'$. Let $K = \max\{k,\ell,1\}$ and let q be an even multiple of the exponent of A'. Put $u = \mathtt{a}^K(\mathtt{abc})^q\mathtt{a}^K$ and $v = \mathtt{a}^K(\mathtt{bac})^q\mathtt{a}^K$. Both are long, with prefix $\mathtt{a}^k$ and suffix $\mathtt{a}^\ell$, and $g'(u) = g'(\mathtt{a})^{2K} = g'(v)$. But u contains q occurrences of $\mathtt{ab}$, while v contains exactly one, at $\mathtt{a}^K\mathtt{b}$. So $h_{\mathtt{ab}}(u) \neq h_{\mathtt{ab}}(v)$, a contradiction. Membership in **LG** follows from Theorem C.4. Non-membership in $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{G}$ follows from the companion characterization that every typing with such a positive image is refined on positive words by a fixed window together with a finite-group morphism [25, Lemma 7.4]; u, v above are nonempty. □

Lemma C.6 (Heavy antichains for sliding-factor typing)**.** *Let G be a reduced good MCFG of fan-out at most f, $\lambda = \lambda_{k,g}$ for a finite group A, and $b \geq 1$. Let T minimize first total yield length and then node count among terminal derivations from one fixed nonterminal with the same componentwise root λ-value. Suppose each node v of T with total yield length $> b$ has a fixed replacement derivation from the same nonterminal, with the same componentwise $h_\Sigma^{k,k}$-value and total yield length at most b. Then any antichain of these nodes has fewer than $M_{A,f}$ elements, with $M_{A,f}$ as in Lemma B.5.*

Proof. Suppose $v_1, \ldots, v_m$ form such an antichain with $m \geq M_{A,f}$. By linearity and nondeletion, each v_i contributes at most f pairwise disjoint, contiguous blocks to the root components. Replacing any nonempty subset by its chosen derivations is valid and strictly reduces the root yield length. The uniform part of Lemma C.3 ensures that *every* such replacement preserves the root window vector. Short root components are unchanged, and the $\gamma_{k,g}$-value of each long root component is an ordered product of fixed slots and block slots, where a replaced block contributes its replacement $\gamma_{k,g}$-value.

Each node has one of at most U_f unary patterns (block count, root-component destinations and block orders within one node). At least $N_{A,f}^{2^{f^2}}$ nodes have one pattern. For their at most f block types and at most f^2 pairs sharing a root component, Lemma B.4 yields at least $N_{A,f}$ indices with uniform cross-index orders; their within-index orders are fixed by the pattern. Regard the blocks of all other antichain nodes as unchanged fixed slots. On each long root component the selected

slots satisfy the hypotheses of Lemma B.3. That lemma supplies a nonempty interval of indices whose simultaneous replacement preserves every long root component's group value. The unchanged window types and short components then preserve the entire root λ-vector, in contradiction to the minimality of T. □

Lemma C.7 (Short tuples with prescribed local-group type)**.** *Let $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ be a reduced good MCFG of fan-out at most f and rule rank at most $r_{\max} \geq 1$, and let $\lambda = \lambda_{k,g}$. Let $b_{\mathrm{w}} := f(2k+1)n_{\mathrm{w}}(r_{\max}+1)\bar{\theta}_G$, where $n_{\mathrm{w}} \leq |V||M_{k,k}|^f$ is the number of non-start typed nonterminals of the trimmed $h_\Sigma^{k,k}$-refinement. Put $n_\lambda := |V||M_{k,g}|^f$, and let $M_{A,f}$ be the constant of Lemma B.5. For every $B \in V$ and every realizable $\mathbf{t} \in M_{k,g}^{\mathrm{fan}(B)}$ there is $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$ with $\lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$ and*

$$\|\vec{u}\|_1 \leq \beta_\lambda := (r_{\max}+1)\, b_{\mathrm{w}} \max\{1, (M_{A,f}-1)\, n_\lambda\}.$$

Proof. Choose a terminal derivation T from B with root type $\mathbf{t}$ that minimizes first total yield length and then node count. Label each node by its nonterminal and the λ-vector of its yield. No label repeats on a path: replacing an earlier subtree by a later one with the same nonterminal and λ-vector preserves the root λ-vector by Lemma C.2, does not increase total yield length, and strictly reduces node count. This contradicts lexicographic minimality, so each path has at most n_λ nodes.

Call a node *heavy* if its yield has total length greater than b_{w}; heavy nodes are ancestor-closed. Let v be a heavy node labelled by C, and let $\boldsymbol{\omega}$ be the $h_\Sigma^{k,k}$-vector of its yield. Since G is reduced, T can be inserted into a successful derivation. Hence $C_{\boldsymbol{\omega}}$ is a retained typed nonterminal of the trimmed $h_\Sigma^{k,k}$-refinement, and Lemma 4.8 supplies a derivation from C whose yield has the same window vector and total length at most b_{w}. Fix this replacement for every heavy node.

Apply Lemma C.6 with $b = b_{\mathrm{w}}$ to the replacements fixed above. Every antichain of heavy nodes has fewer than $M_{A,f}$ elements. Since heavy nodes are ancestor-closed and every root-to-leaf path has at most n_λ nodes, their depth levels give at most $(M_{A,f}-1)n_\lambda$ heavy nodes.

Hence the heavy nodes number at most $(M_{A,f}-1)n_\lambda$. Each heavy node writes at most $\bar{\theta}_G \leq b_{\mathrm{w}}$ terminals and has at most $r_{\max}$ light children, each of yield length at most b_{w}. If the root is light, its length is at most b_{w}. □

Proof of Theorem 4.10. By Theorem C.4, $h \preceq \lambda_{k,g}$ for some k, A, g depending only on h. Let $X = B_{\mathbf{s}}$ be a non-start typed nonterminal of the trimmed h-refinement and $\vec{u} \in L_X$. Lemma C.7, applied to the λ-vector of $\vec{u}$, gives $\vec{u}' \in L_B(G)$ with the same λ-vector, hence the same h-vector, and $\|\vec{u}'\|_1 \leq \beta_\lambda$. By Proposition 3.12(ii) its derivation lifts to root X, and it survives trimming as in Lemma 4.8. So canonical tuples of length at most $\beta_\lambda = O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$ exist. Here we use $b_{\mathrm{w}} = O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$ and $n_\lambda = O(\|G\|)$. Lemma 4.7 bounds every witness word by $2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max}\beta_\lambda$, and Proposition 3.17 bounds their number by $O(\|G\|)$. □

Theorem 4.10 contains the window and window–group theorems as special cases (Proposition C.5(i)), with the same exponent three in the group case.

Remark C.8 (Pseudovariety scope). Theorem 4.10 covers positive-image pseudovarieties contained in **LG**. Beyond **LG**, the two-element semilattice U_1 occurs as a subsemigroup (Theorem C.4), while the companion CFG paper supplies a fan-out-one exponential lower bound [25]. This does not resolve the higher-fan-out problem in Open Problem 6.1.

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